Leon’s Thinking Book

Volume 1 · Ages 4–6

Written and illustrated by **Robert de Farias**

Leon’s Thinking Book — Volume 1 (Ages 4–6)
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Safety: For children aged 4 and up. Use crayons or colored pencils. Adult supervision is recommended.

This book offers playful practice for young children. It is not a test, a diagnosis or a substitute for advice from a teacher or health professional.

This book belongs to

Draw yourself in the frame!

My name

Hello, grown-ups!

Leon's Thinking Book is a playful activity book for children aged 4 to 6. Many of the games are made with real artworks by Robert de Farias: his lines, his colors and his paintings.

The activities give children lots of chances to practice looking carefully, remembering, noticing shapes and patterns, simple logic, counting, early reading, thinking about space and naming feelings.

A few tips

• Keep it short: 10 to 15 minutes is plenty.
• Read the instructions aloud. Most children of this age don't read yet.
• Praise effort and good tries, not only right answers.
• It is fine to skip a page and come back later.
• Talk about the pictures. Ask "How did you find it?"

The answers are at the back of the book, on pages 76 to 79.

Have fun together!

How to use this book

One star: an easy start.

Two stars: time to think a little more.

Listen: a grown-up reads something aloud.

Look and remember: look, then turn the page.

Leon is your thinking friend. He tries, makes mistakes and tries again!

Luz lights up when you have an idea.

My star chart

Color a star for every page you try!

8

9

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

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71

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73

74

Leon & Luz’s island map

Visit all 9 islands!

Look closely
page 8

Remember
page 16

Shapes
page 24

Logic
page 36

Patterns
page 30

Numbers
page 43

Words
page 52

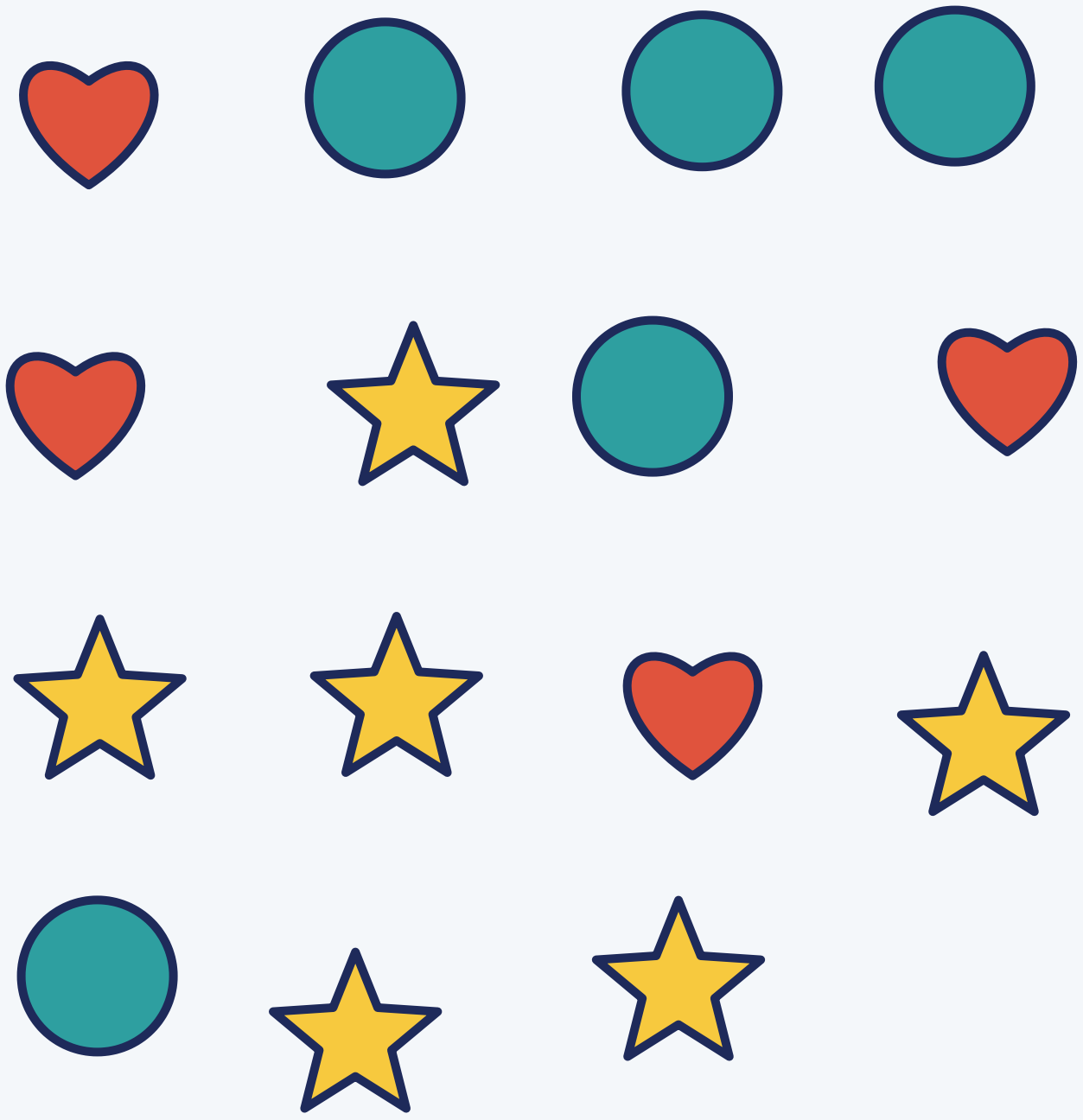
Space
page 60

Feelings
page 66

Big Challenge: page 72

Find the stars

Circle all the stars.



Sock pairs

Draw a line between the socks that are the same.

Odd one out

Three circles in each row come from the same painting. Circle the one with different colors.

1

2

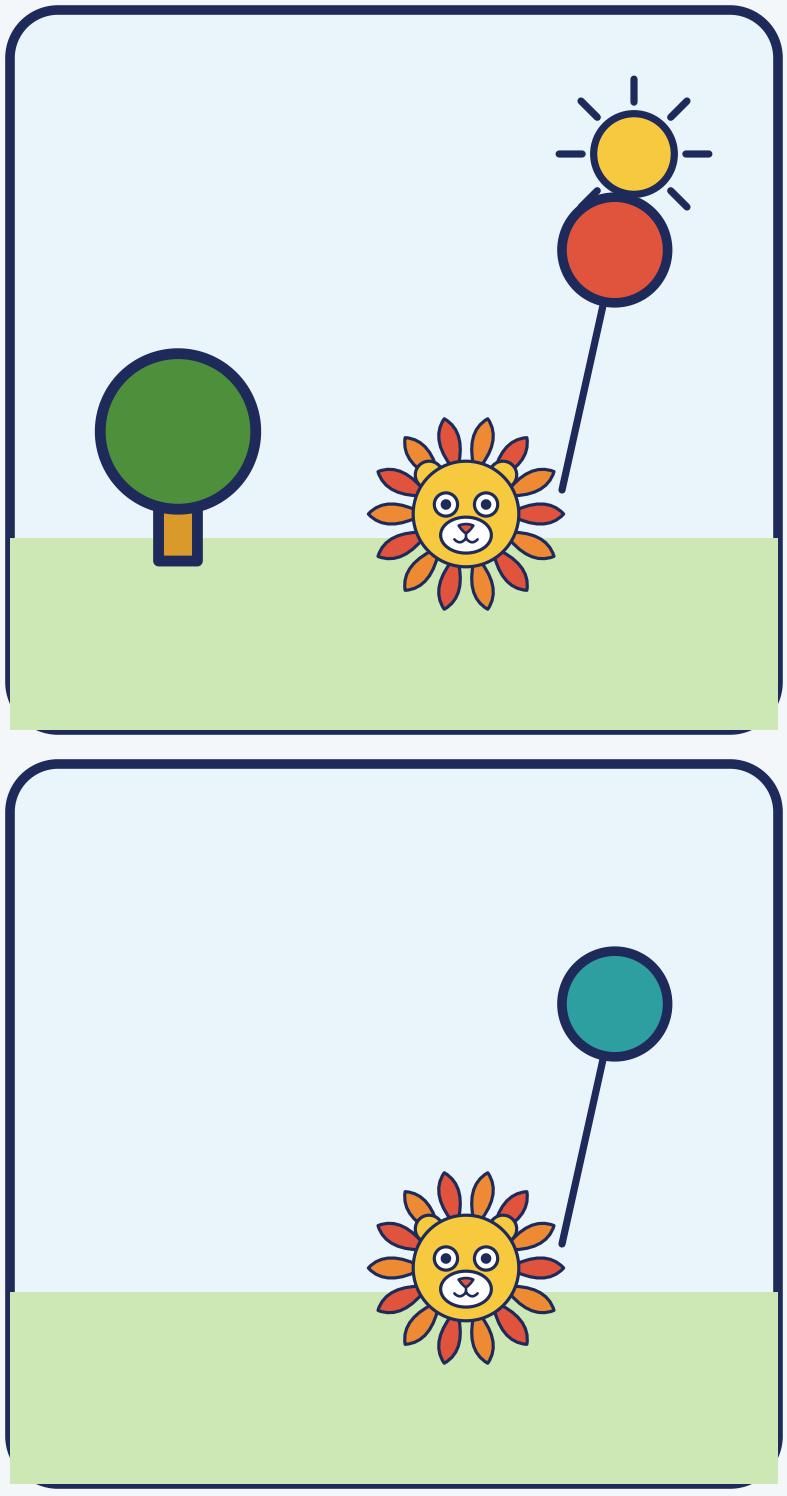
3

4

Artwork: Robert de Farias

3 little differences

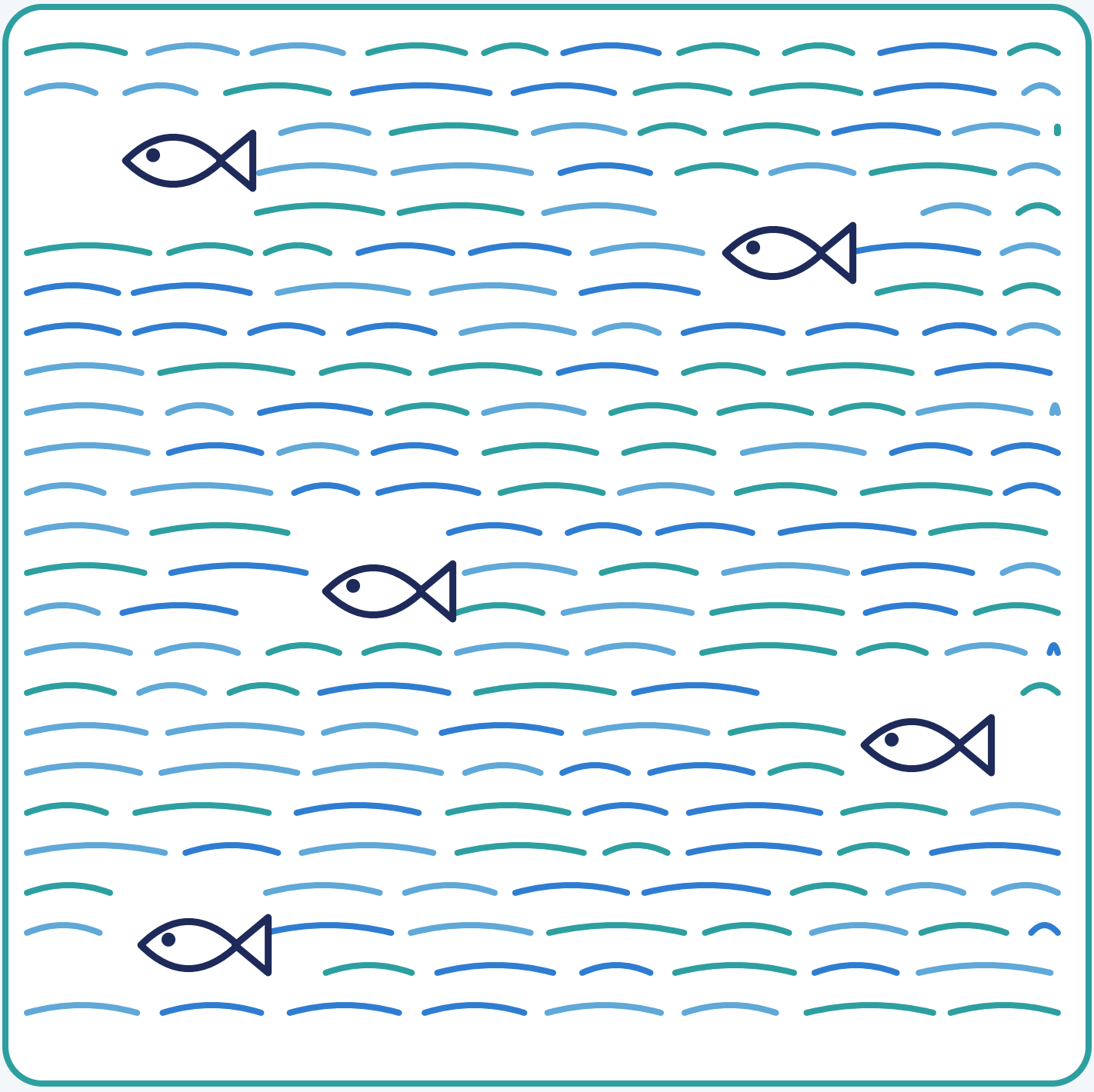
Look at both pictures. Find 3 differences.



Circle the differences in the bottom picture.

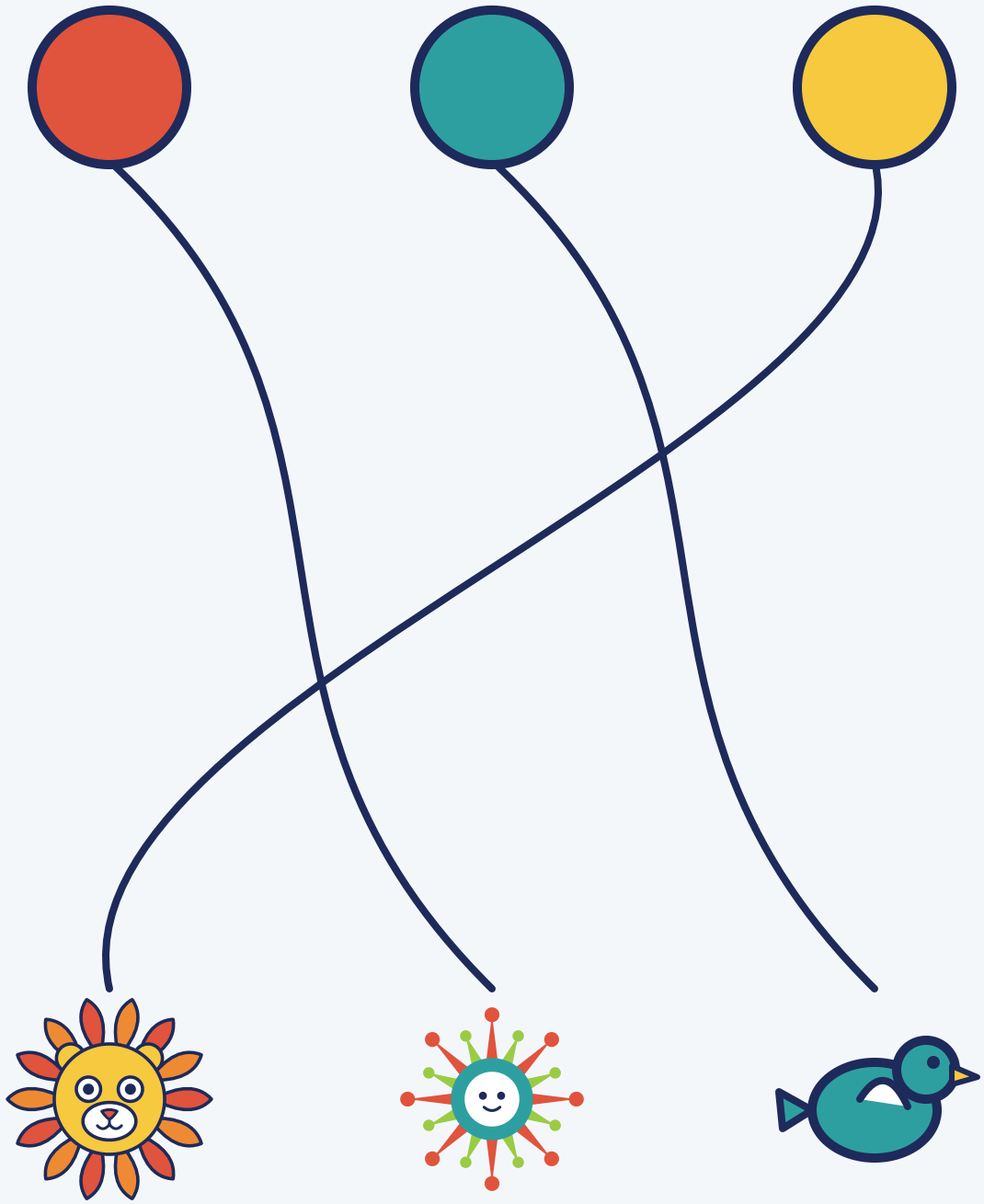
Hidden fish

5 fish are hiding in the waves. Find them and color them.



Balloon strings

Follow the strings. Who has the red balloon?



Find the shadow

This is Robert’s bird. Which shadow belongs to it? Circle the letter.

A

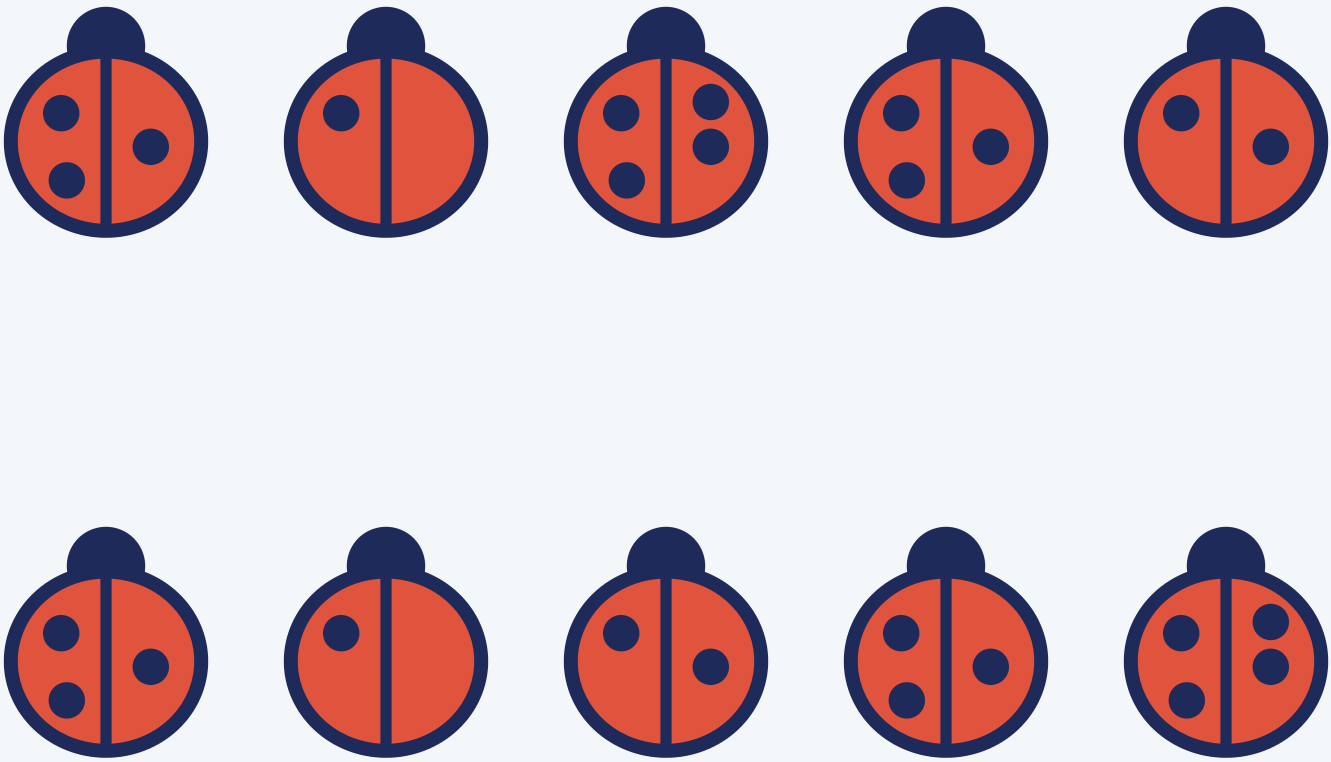
B

C

Artwork: Robert de Farias

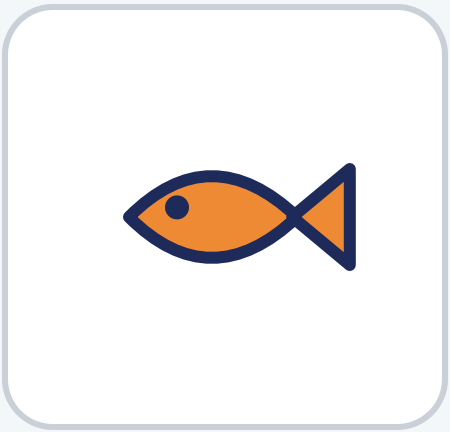
Ladybug spots

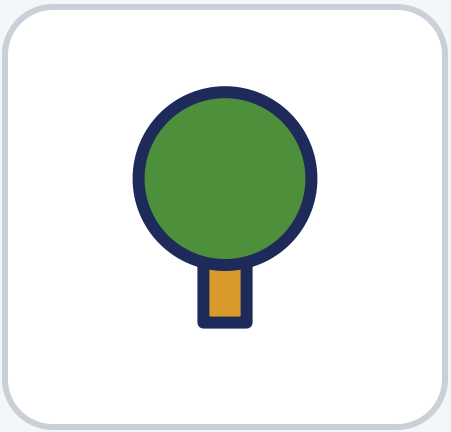
Circle the ladybugs with 3 spots.



Luz goes to the market

Listen. Circle the 3 things Luz buys.





For grown-ups: read this once, slowly: “Luz buys an apple, a cup and a star.” Then let your child circle the pictures.

Look and remember

Look at the three circles for 10 seconds.
Then turn the page.

Now turn the page!

Artwork: Robert de Farias

What did you see?

Three of these circles were on the page before. Circle them.

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Three colors

Remember the colors of the circles, from 1 to 3. Then turn the page.

1

2

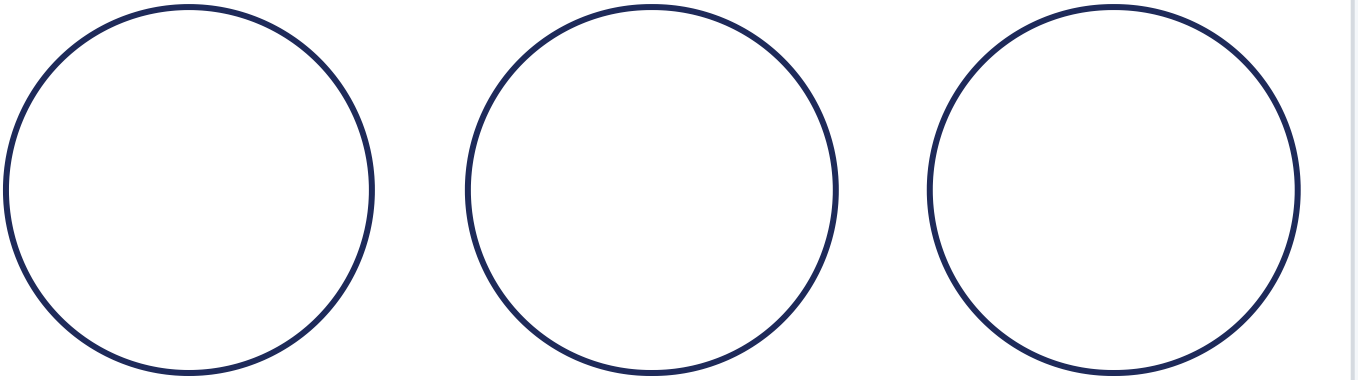
3

Now turn the page!

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Color the circles

Color the circles in the same order you saw.



1 2 3

Robert’s window

Look at the four circles for 10 seconds.
Then turn the page.

Now turn the page!

Artwork: Robert de Farias

What is missing?

One circle is missing. Which one? Circle the letter.

A

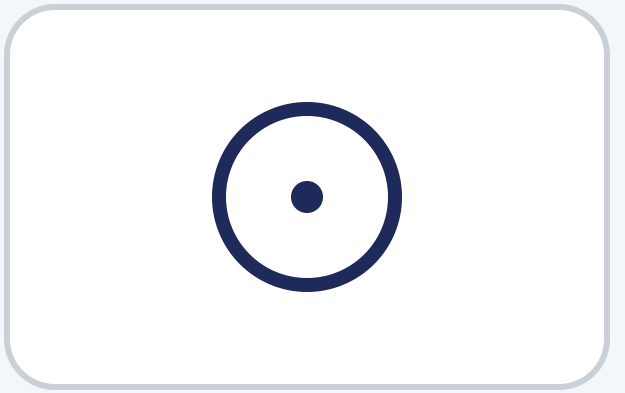
B

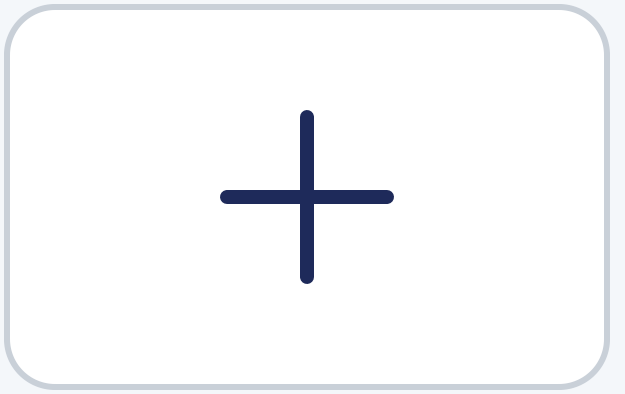
C

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Look, cover, draw

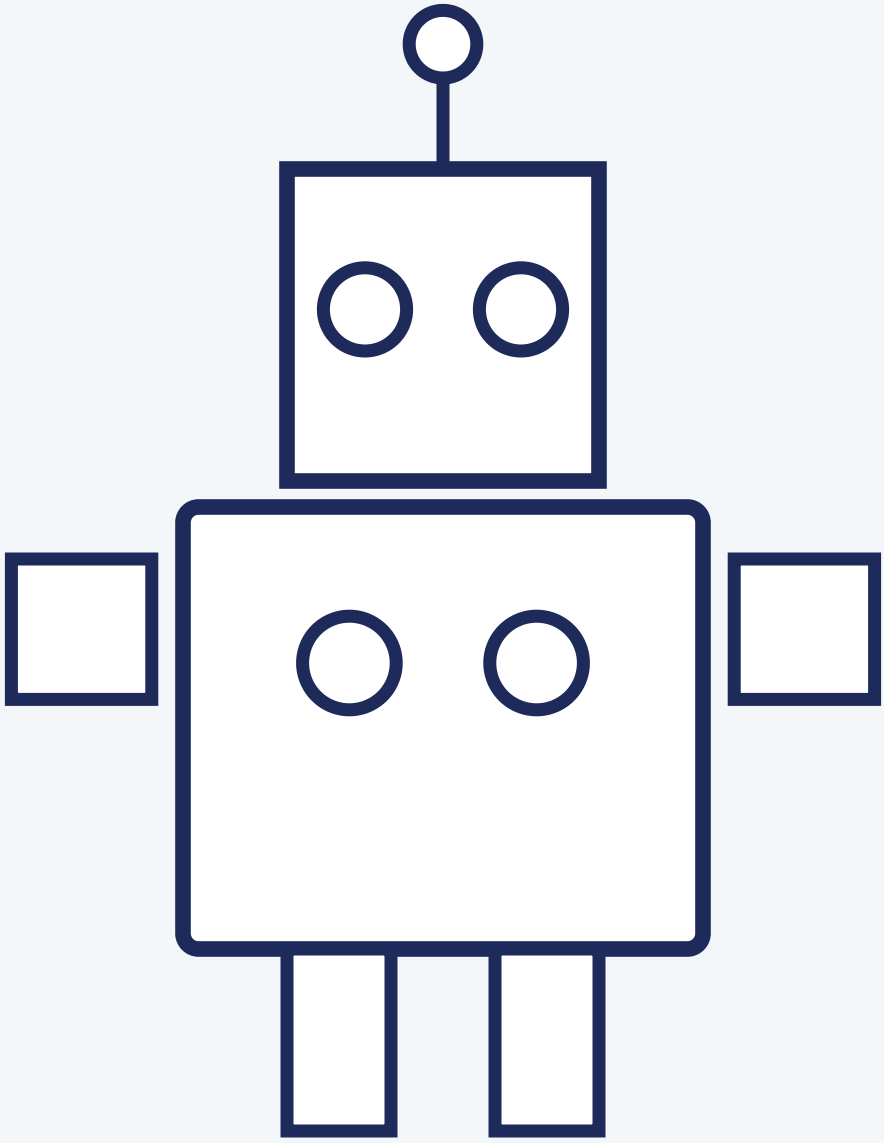
Look at a picture. Cover it with your hand. Draw it in the empty box.





Shape robot

Color the circles red. Color the squares blue.

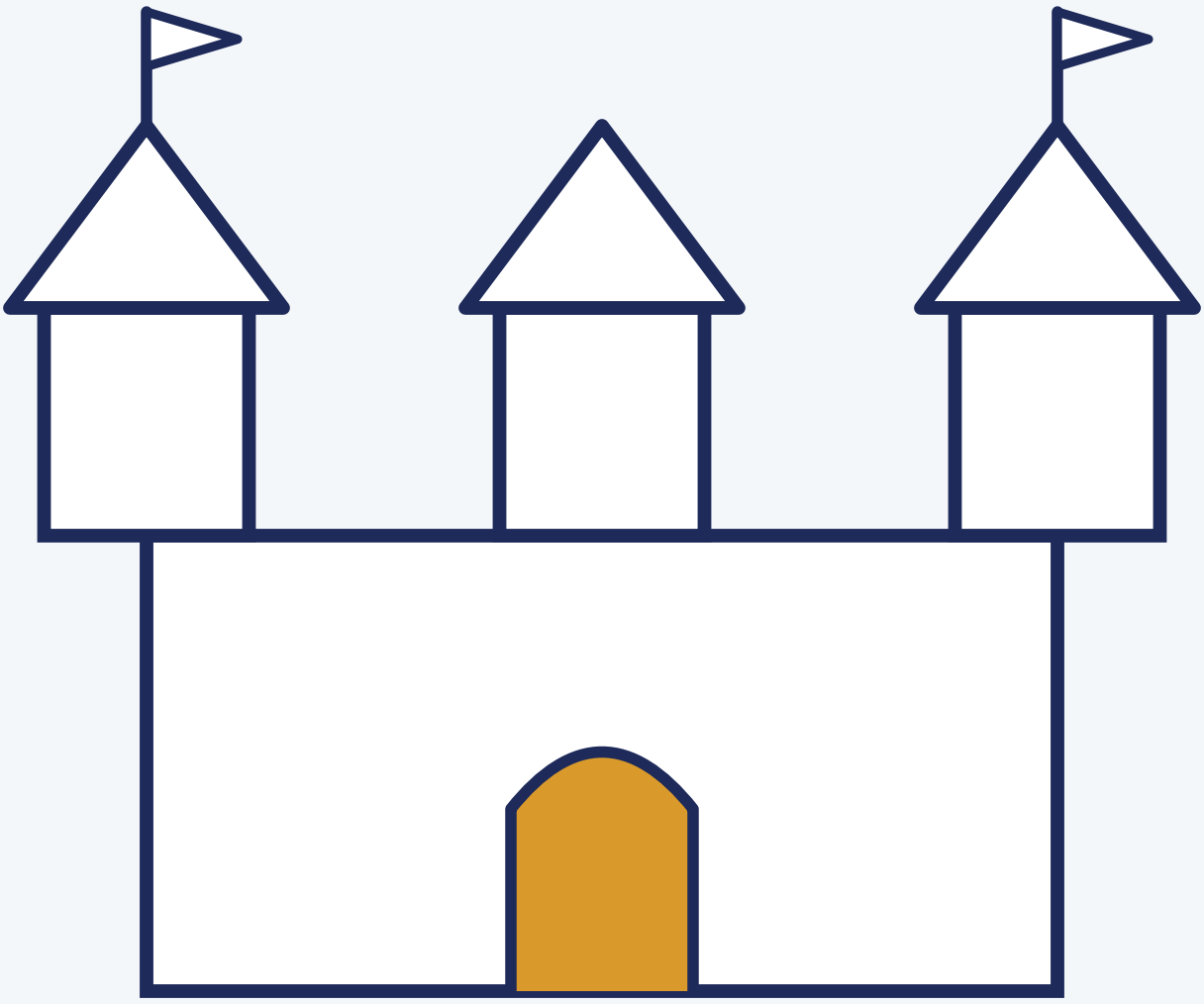


circles

squares

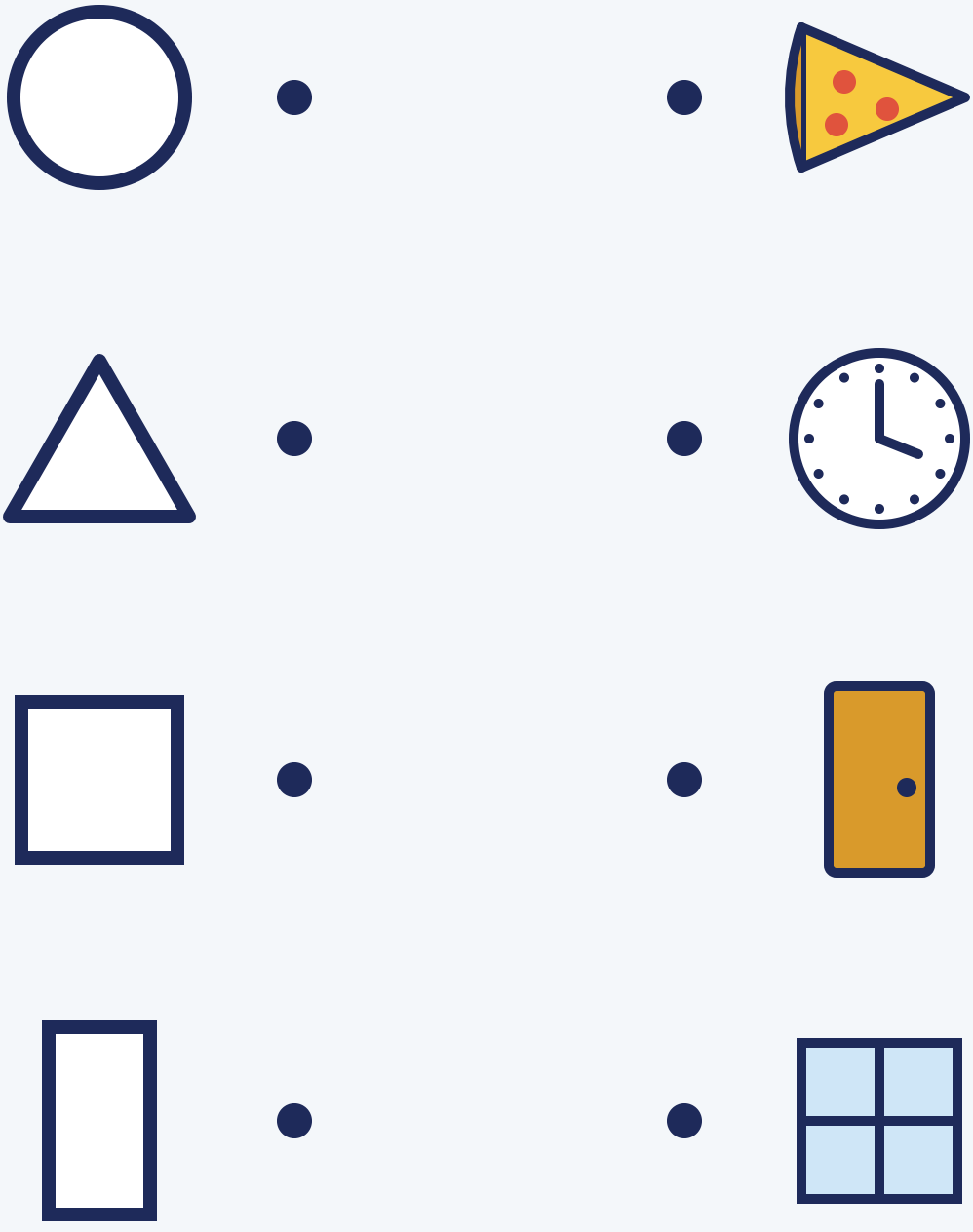
Castle triangles

How many triangles can you find?
Color them and count.



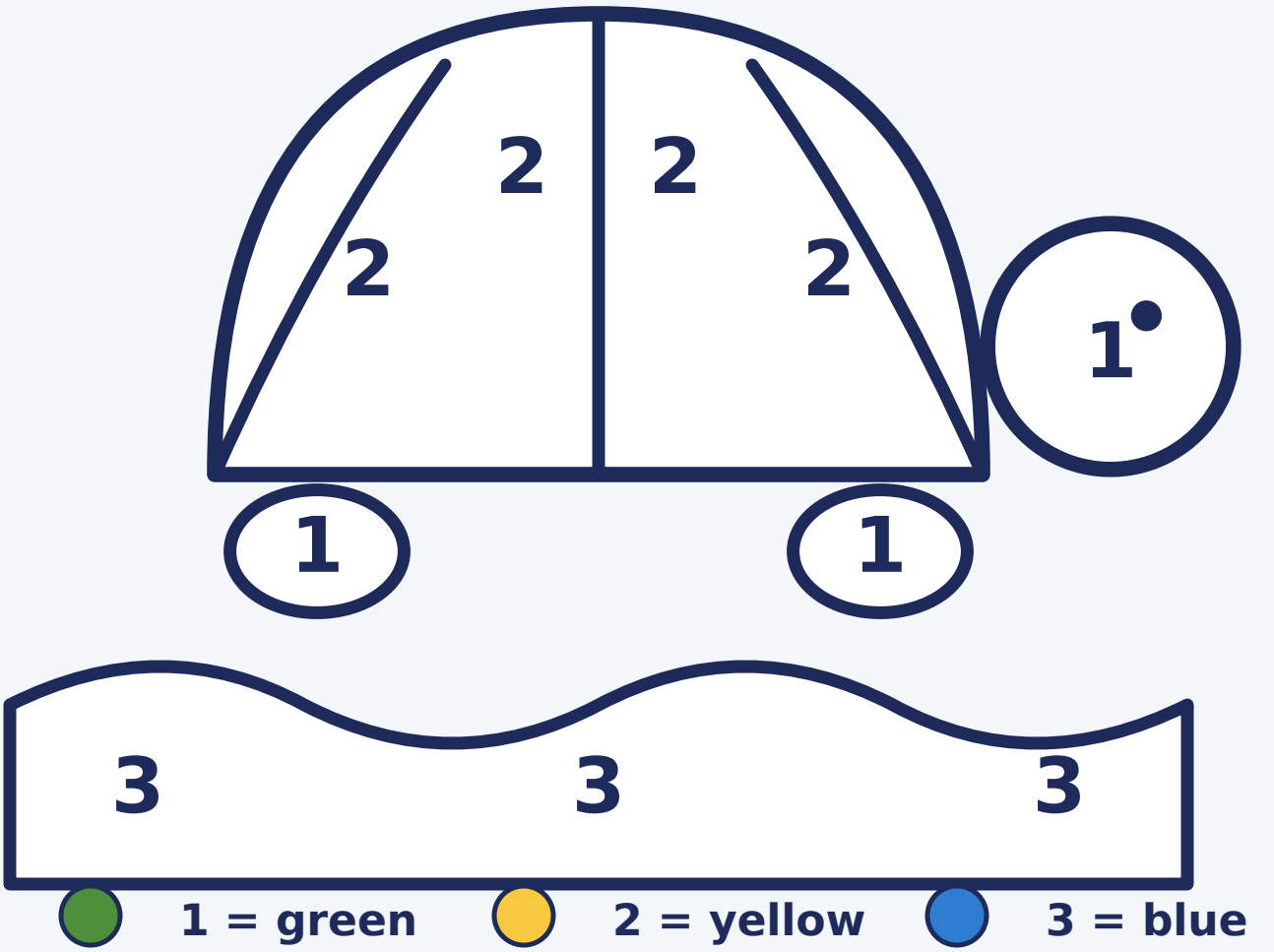
Shapes around us

Draw a line from each shape to a thing with the same shape.



Color by number

Color each part with the color of its number.



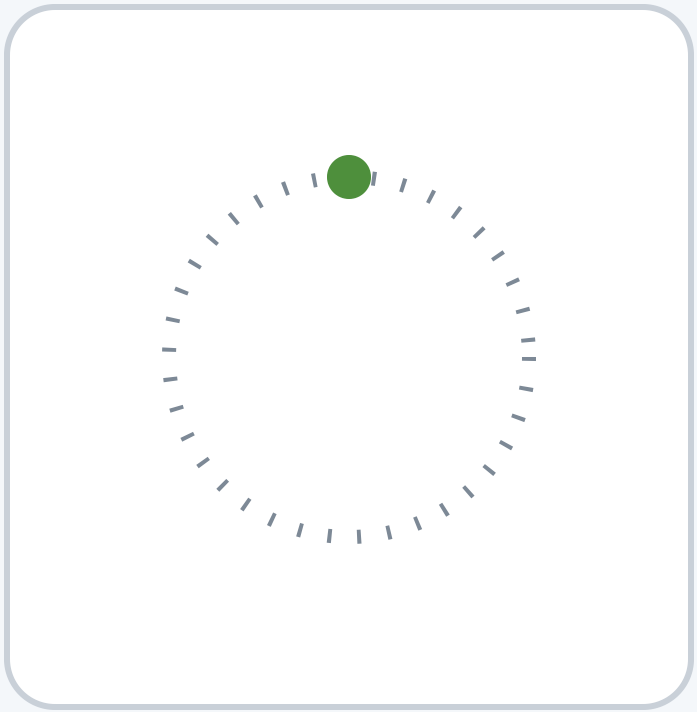
Big and small

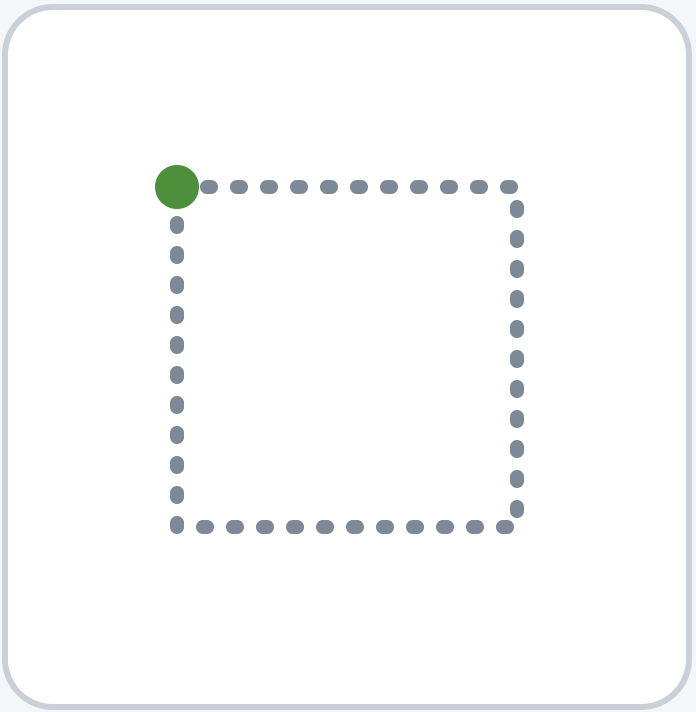
Circle the biggest one. Draw a line under the smallest one.

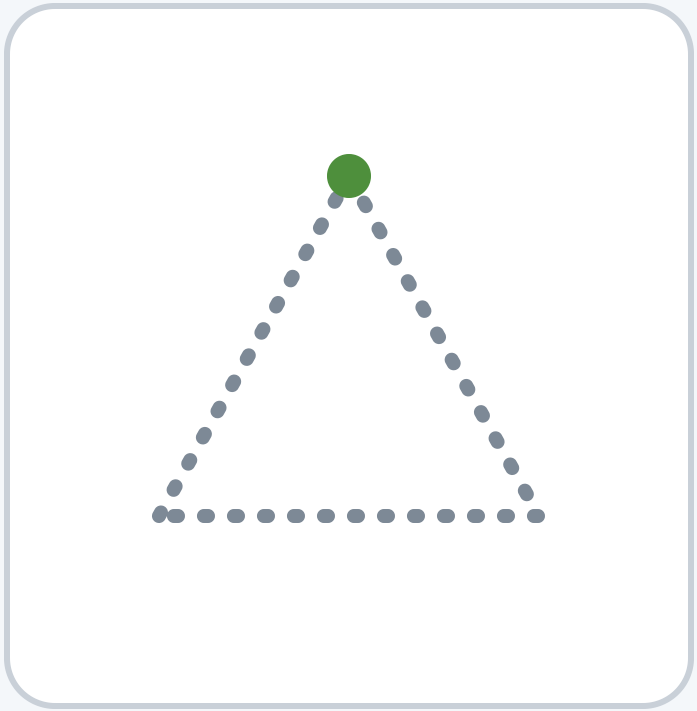
Artwork: Robert de Farias

Trace the shapes

Trace the dotted lines. Start at the green dot.







What comes next?

Look at the colors in each row. Which circle comes next? Circle A or B.

Which one is next?

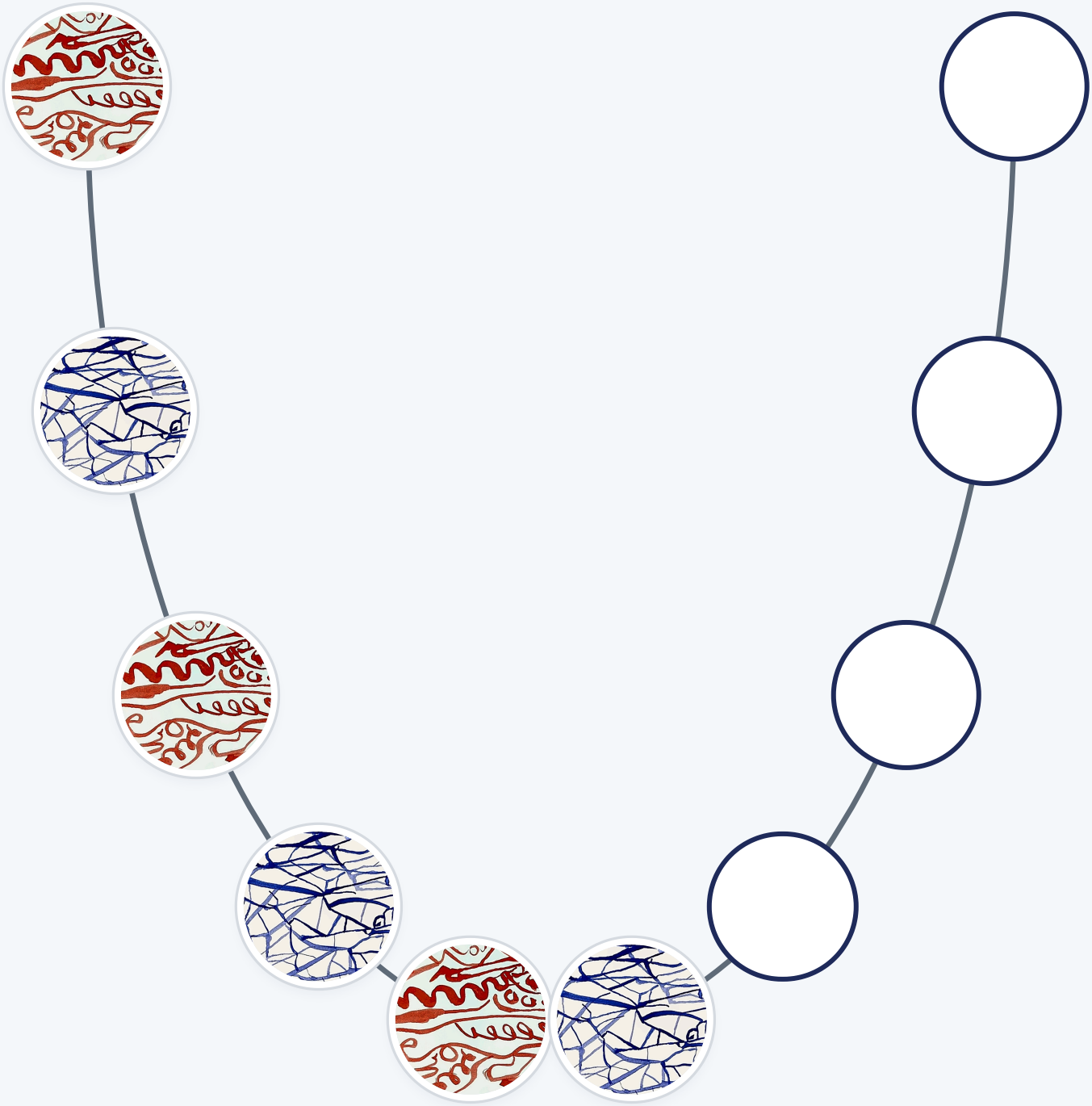
Which one is next?

Which one is next?

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Bead necklace

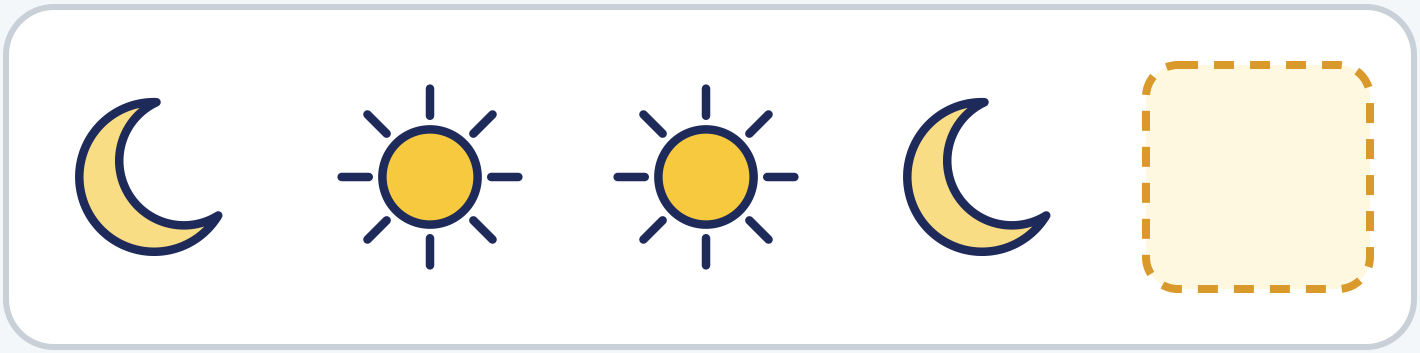
Finish the necklace. Color the white beads to keep the pattern.



Artwork: Robert de Farias

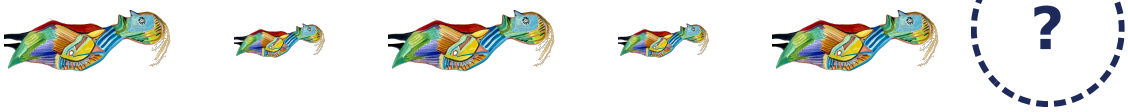
Sun and moon

Look at the pattern. Draw what comes next.

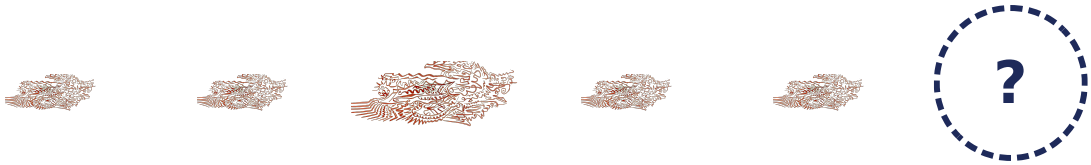


Big, small, big

Look at the sizes. Which one comes next? Circle A or B.



Which one is next?



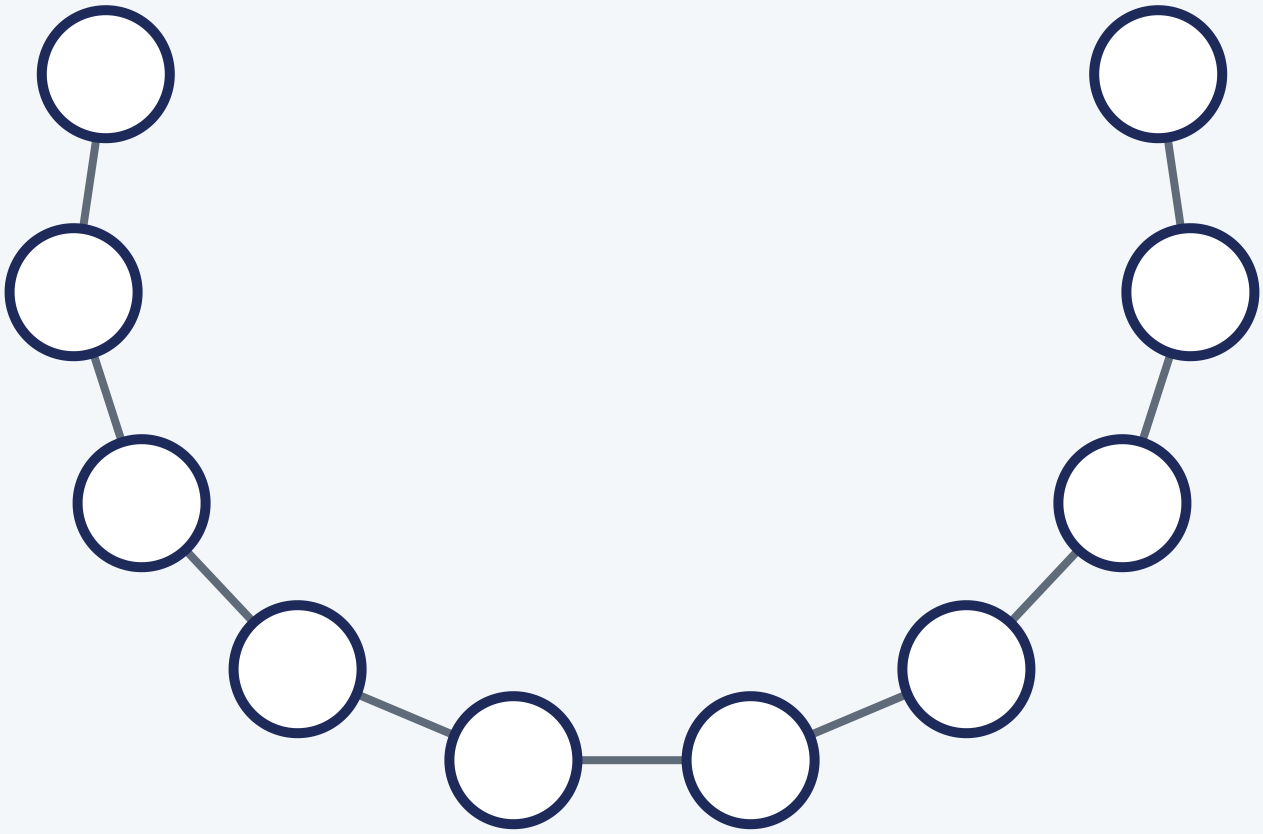
Which one is next?

Which one is next?

Artwork: Robert de Farias

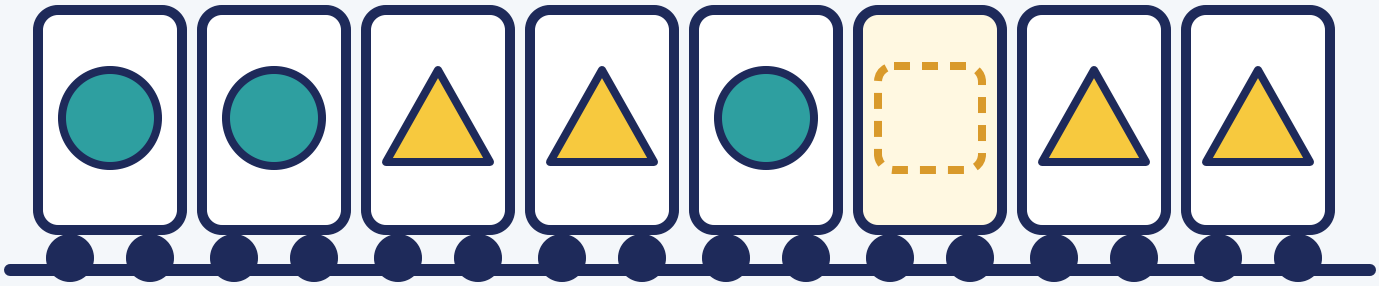
My own pattern

Make your own pattern! Color the beads. Then tell a grown-up your pattern.



Pattern train

One wagon is empty. Draw the missing shape.



What goes together?

Draw a line from each circle to the painting it comes from.

1

2

3

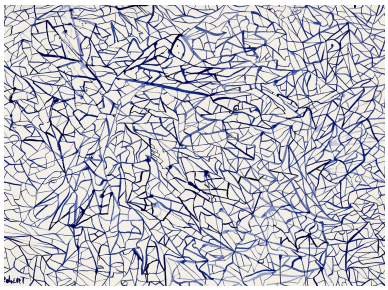
Artwork: Robert de Farias

One color or many?

Draw a line from each picture to the right box.

1

2



3

4

5

6

One color

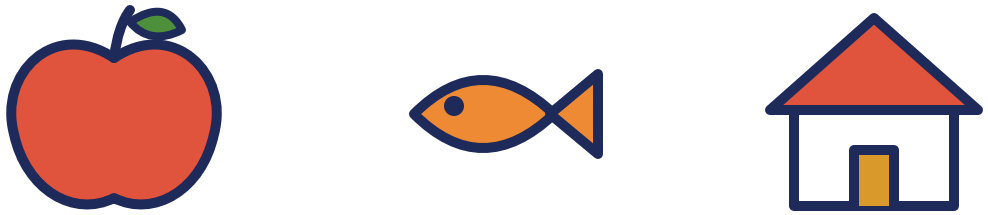
Many colors

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Who am I?

Listen to each riddle. Circle the answer.

1



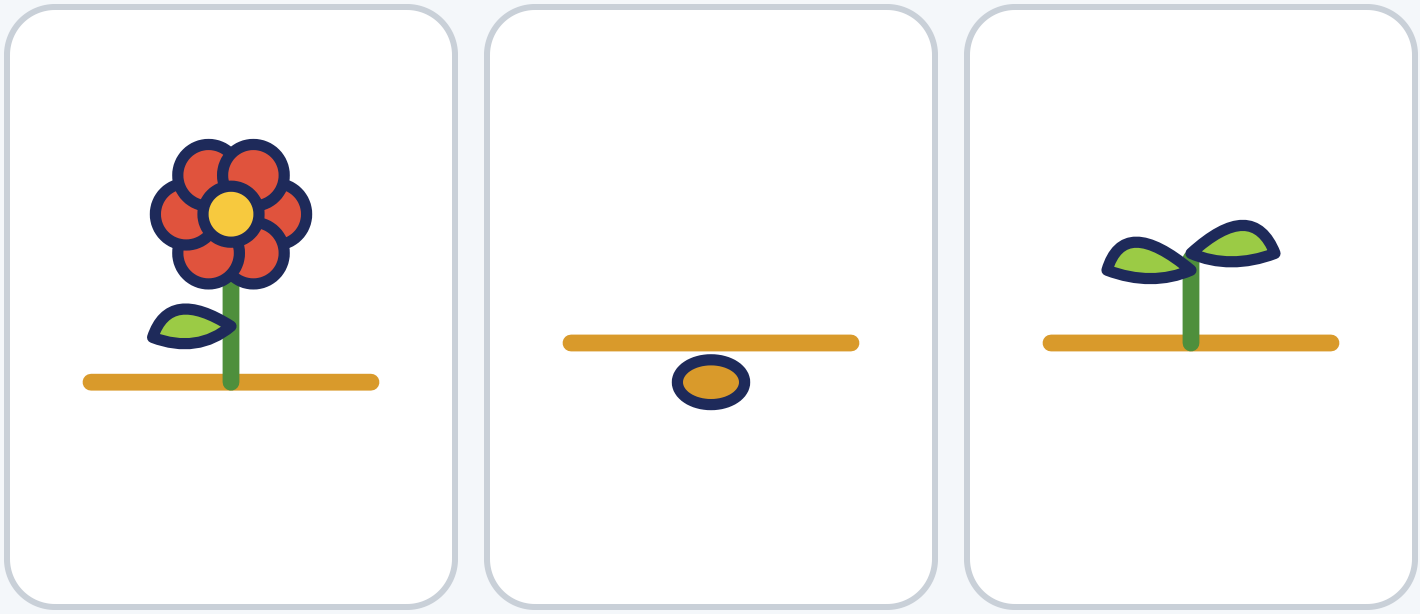
2

3

For grown-ups, read: 1. “I live in the water and I can swim.” 2. “I am hot and yellow. I shine in the sky.” 3. “You can drink from me.”

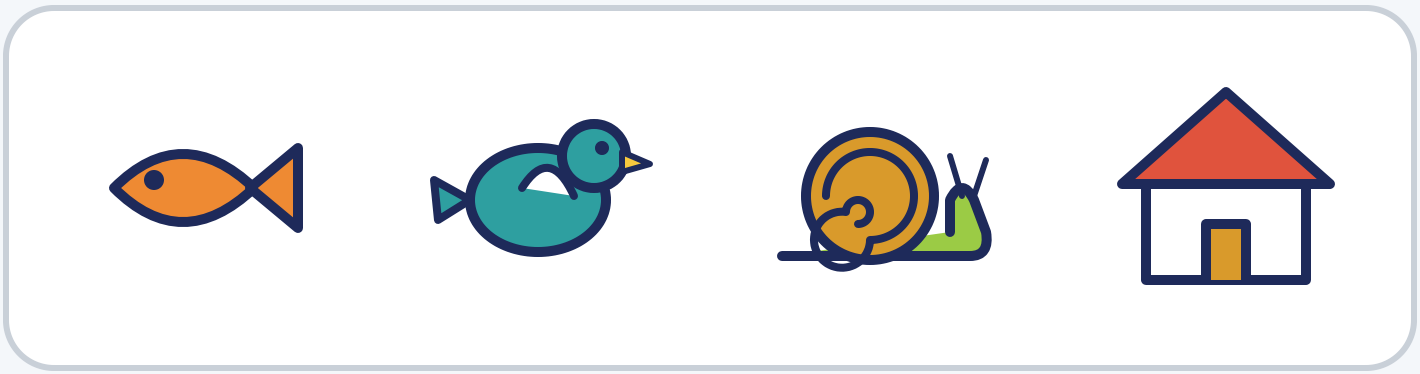
First, next, last

What happens first? Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes.



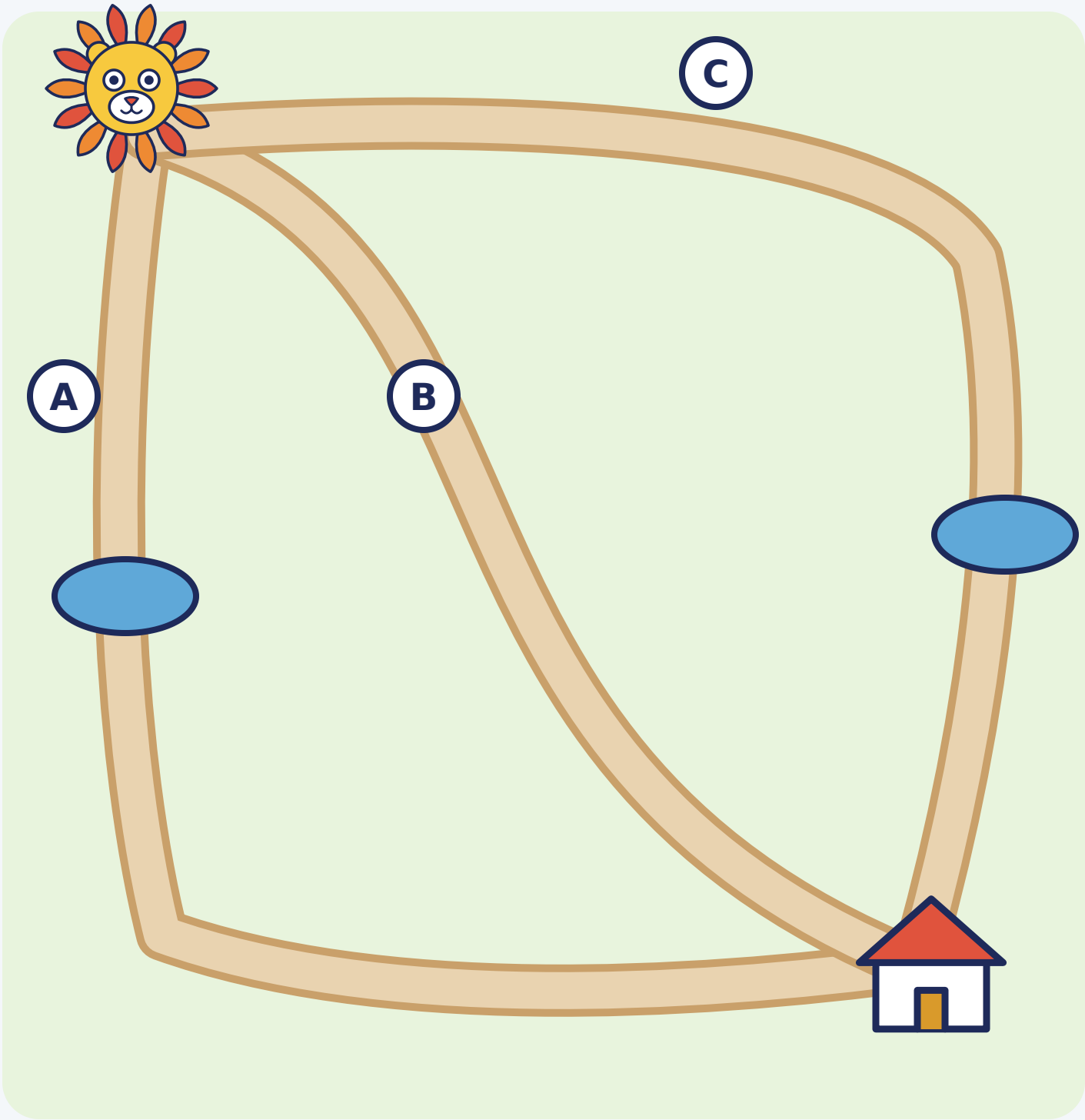
Which does not belong?

Circle the one that does not belong with the others.



Dry feet

Help Leon get home without stepping in a puddle. Which path: A, B or C?



Leon’s color grid

Each color goes once in every row and every column. Color the 3 empty squares.

Artwork: Robert de Farias

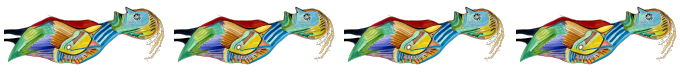
How many?

Count the pictures in each row. Circle the number.

1 2 3 4 5

1 2 3 4 5

1 2 3 4 5

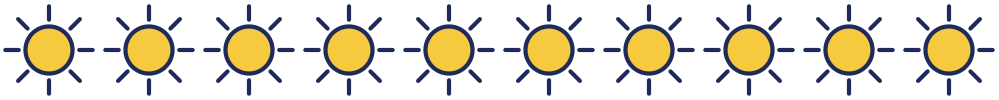


1 2 3 4 5

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Count to 10

Count. Write the number in the box.



Which has more?

In each row, circle the box with more.

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Number path

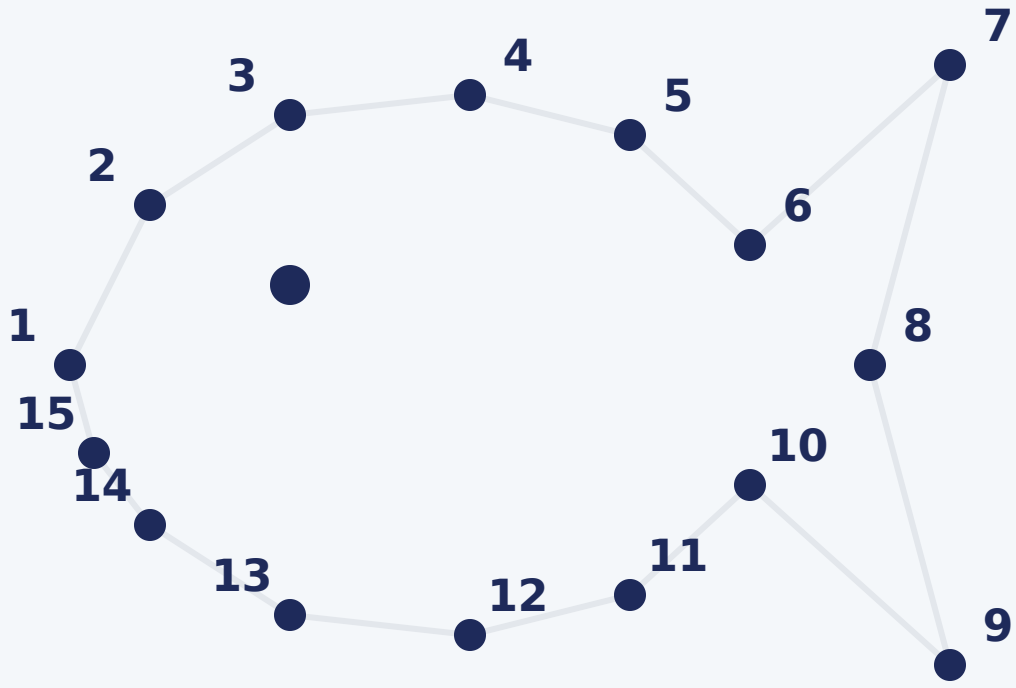
Help Leon reach Luz. Follow the numbers 1, 2, 3 ... 9 in order. Color the path.

1	2	6	4	8
7	3	4	9	2
9	1	5	6	3
2	8	3	7	1
5	3	6	8	9

Move up, down, left or right. No jumping!

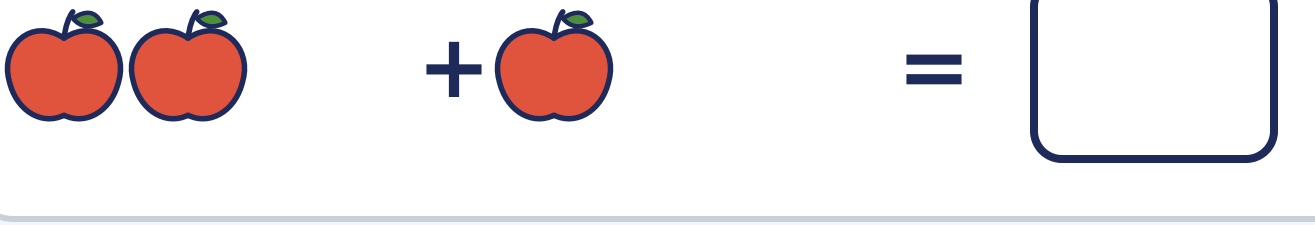
Dot to dot

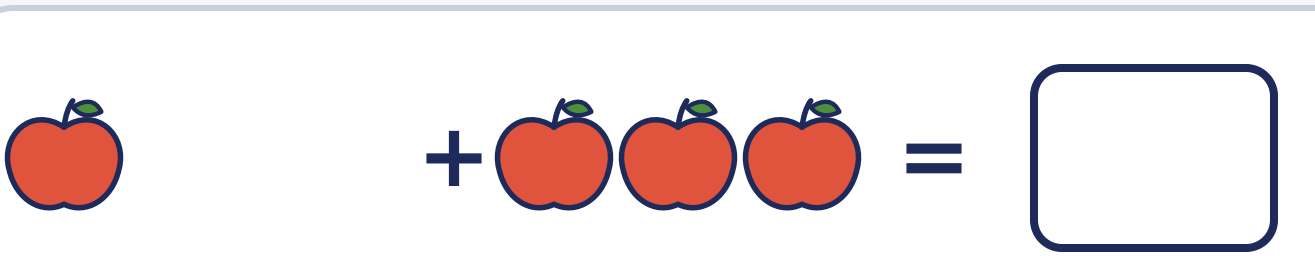
Connect the dots from 1 to 15. Who is hiding?

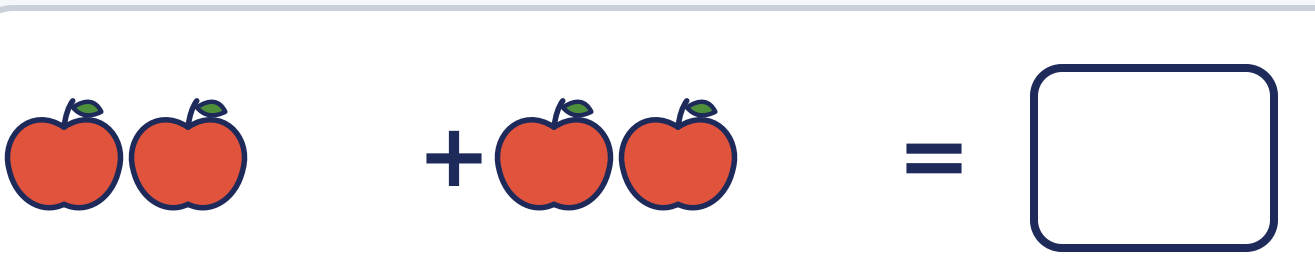


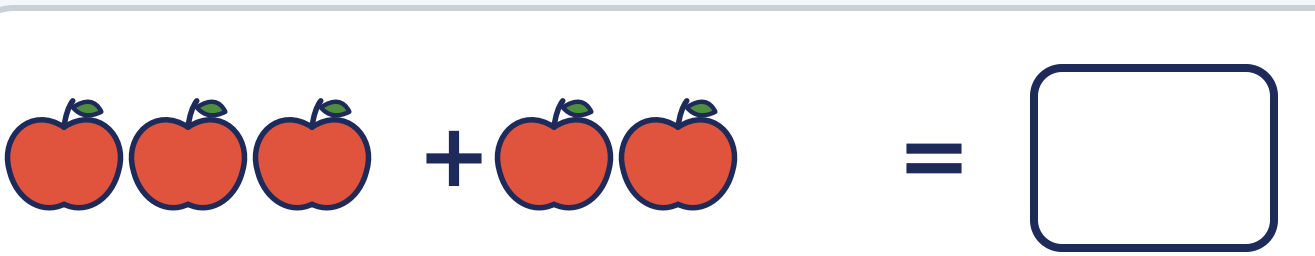
Adding apples

Count all the apples. Write how many in the box.



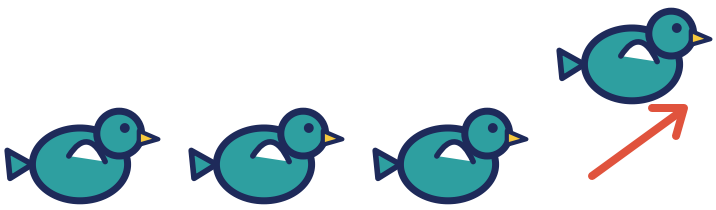


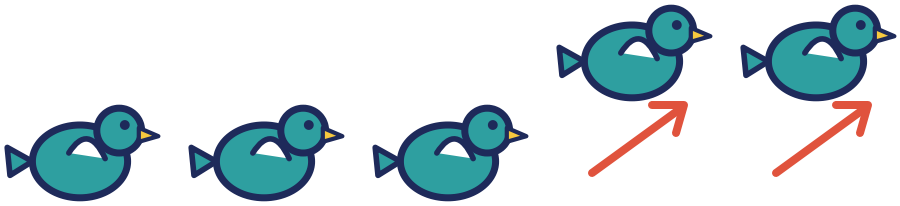


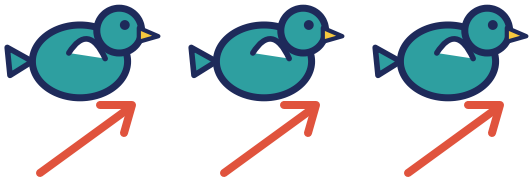


Flying away

Some birds fly away (look at the arrows). How many birds stay?







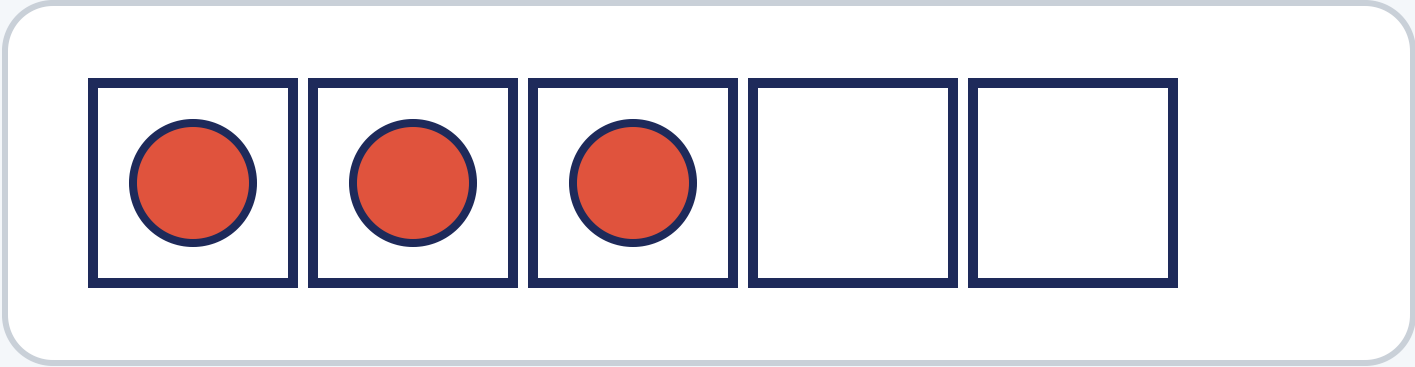
Missing numbers

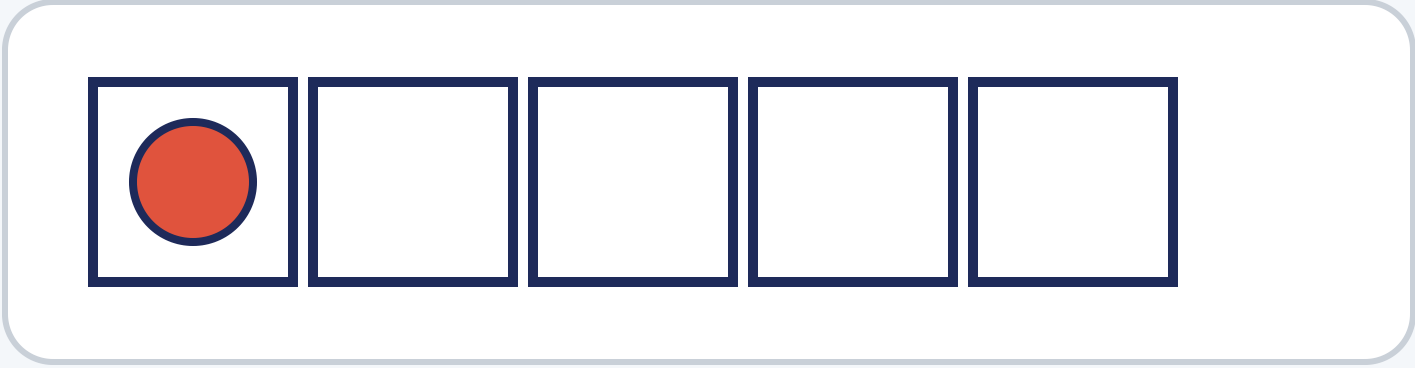
Write the missing number.

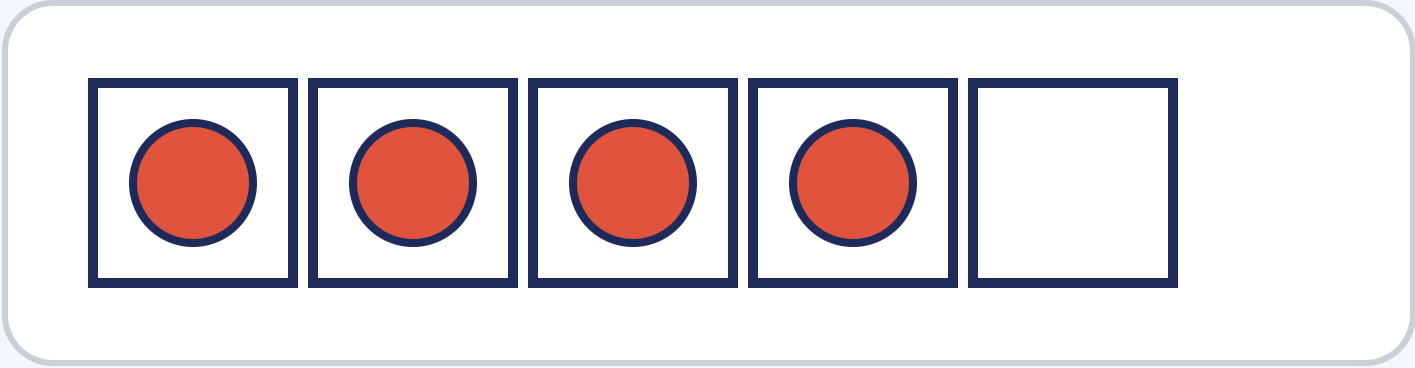
1	2		4	5
3	4		6	7
6		8	9	10
5	6	7		9

Make 5

Draw more dots so each row has 5.
How many did you add?







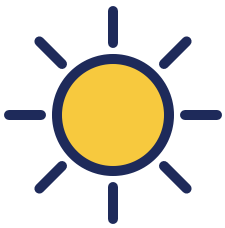
Letter hunt

Circle every A and every a.

B	a	M	S	A	O
T	E	a	C	D	A
U	A	S	M	a	E
O	C	B	A	T	S
D	a	E	O	M	C
S	T	U	D	E	B

First letters

Say the name of each picture. Draw a line to its first letter.



M m

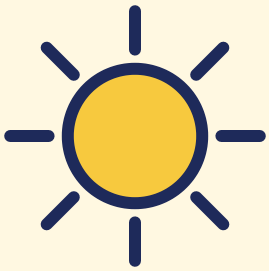
S s

C c

B b

Same first sound

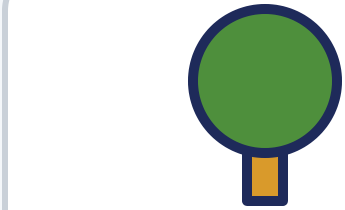
Say “sun”. Circle the pictures that start with the same sound.

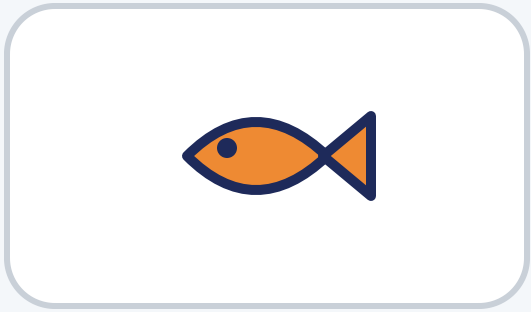


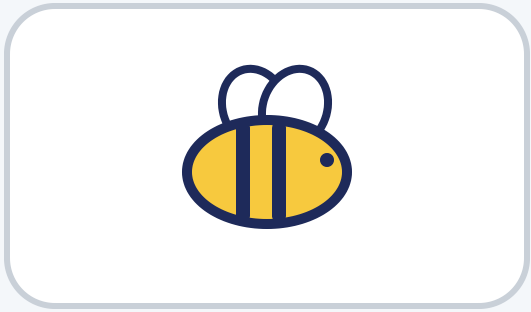
sun

Rhyme time

Say the words. Draw a line between the words that rhyme.







Trace LUZ

Trace Luz’s name. Start at the green dots.

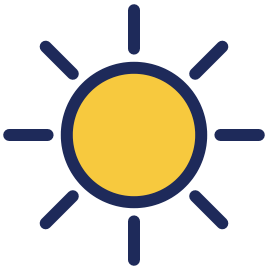
LUZ

LUZ

LUZ

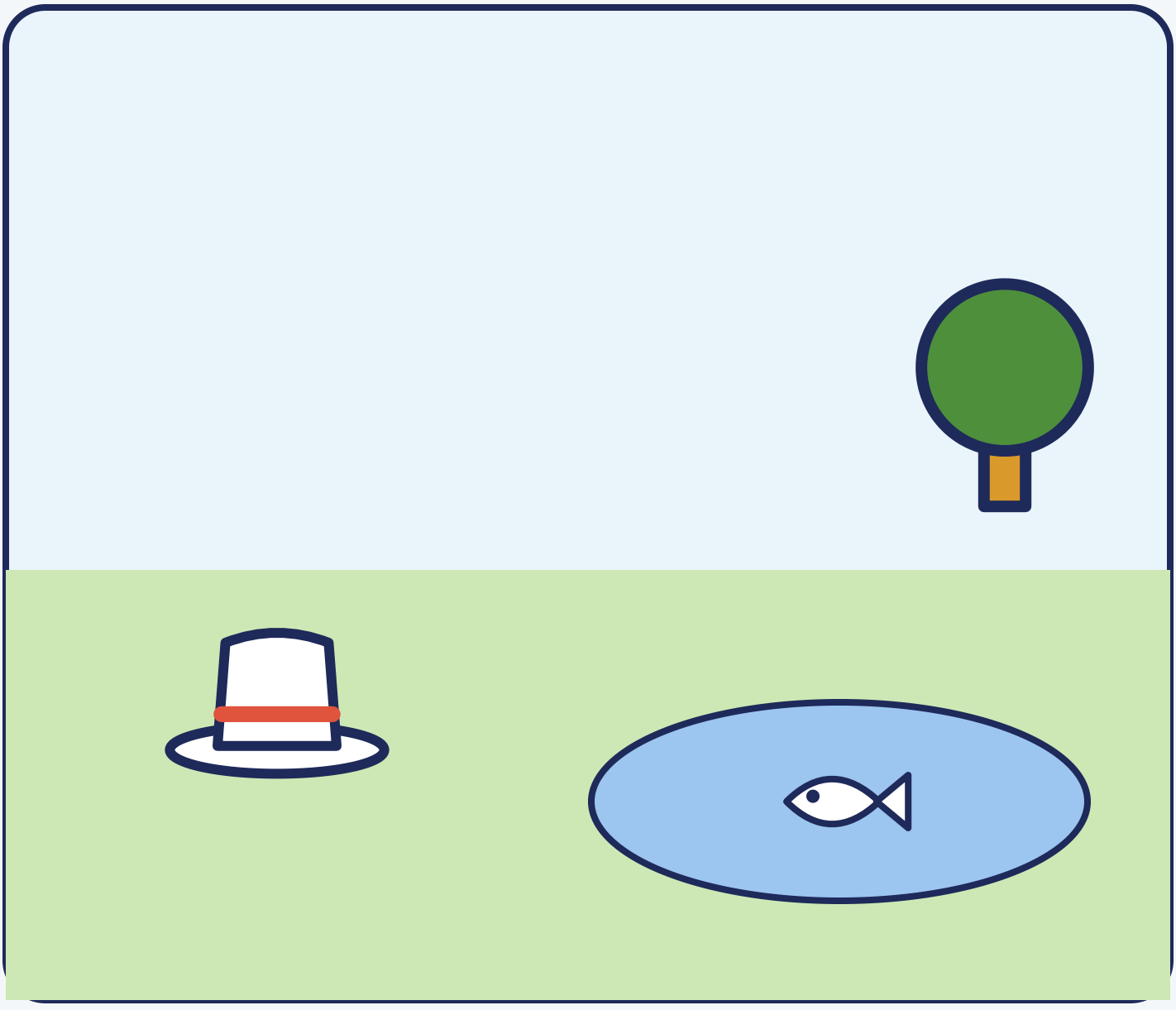
Word and picture

Read the word with a grown-up. Draw a line to the picture.

SUN	
CAT	
CUP	

Listen and do

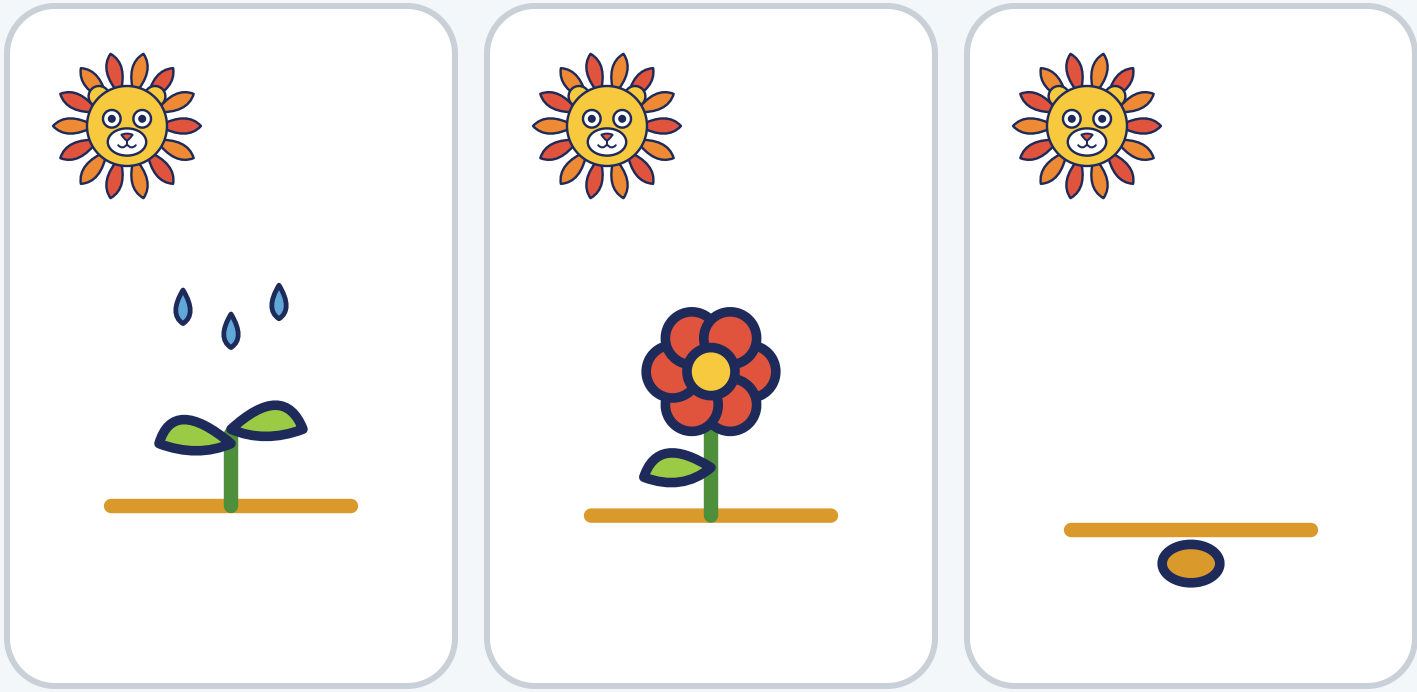
Listen to your grown-up and do what they say.



For grown-ups, read one at a time: 1. “Color the hat blue.” 2. “Draw a sun in the sky.” 3. “Put an X on the fish.”

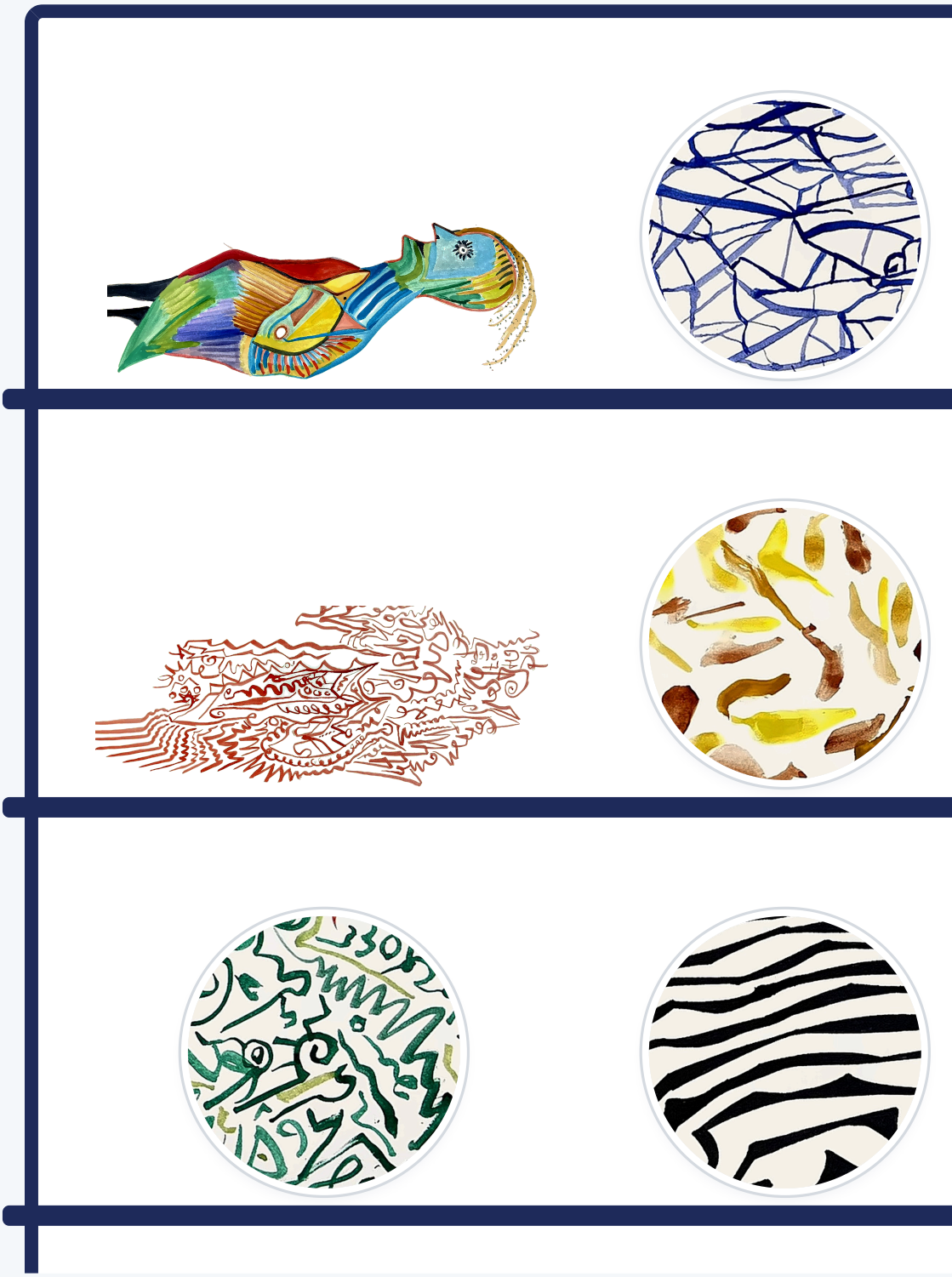
Tell the story

Leon grows a flower. Write 1, 2, 3 in the right order. Then tell the story!



Top shelf

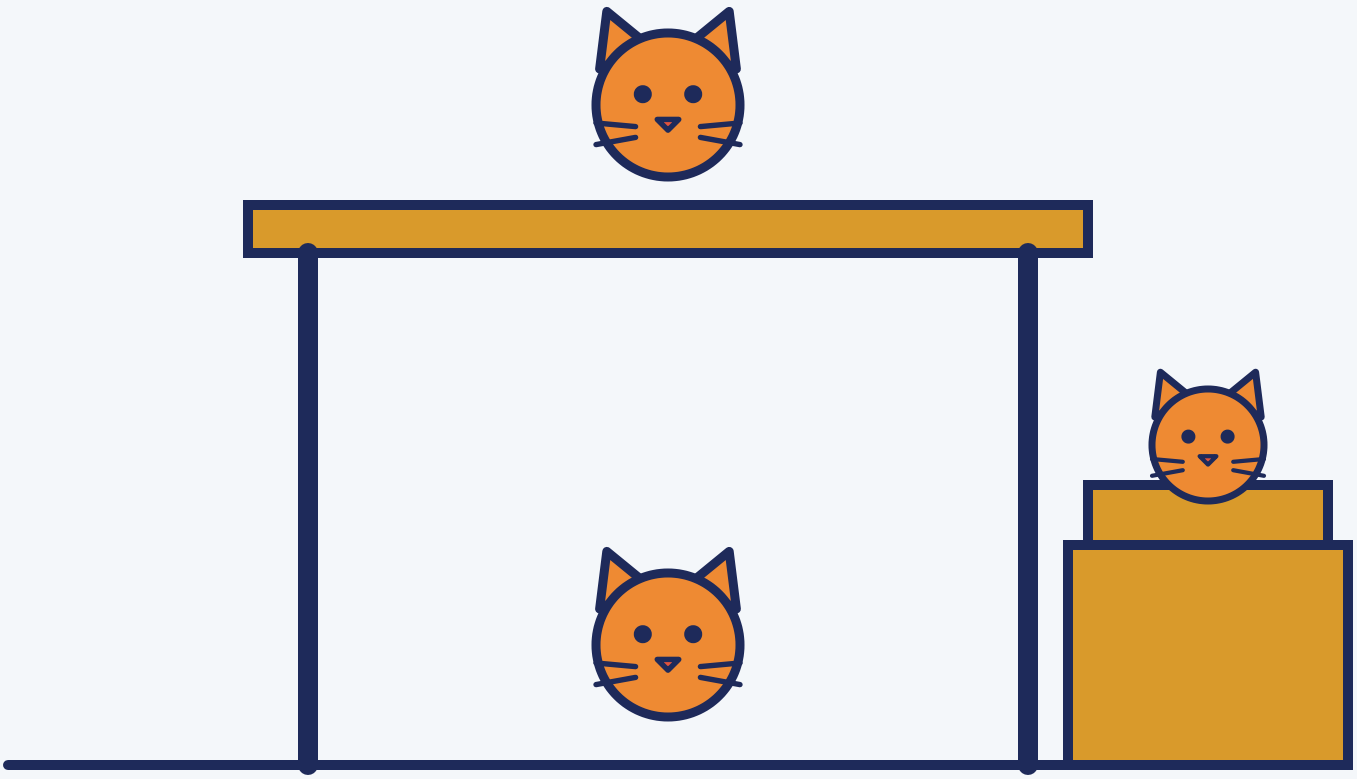
Circle the things on the top shelf.



Artwork: Robert de Farias

Where is the cat?

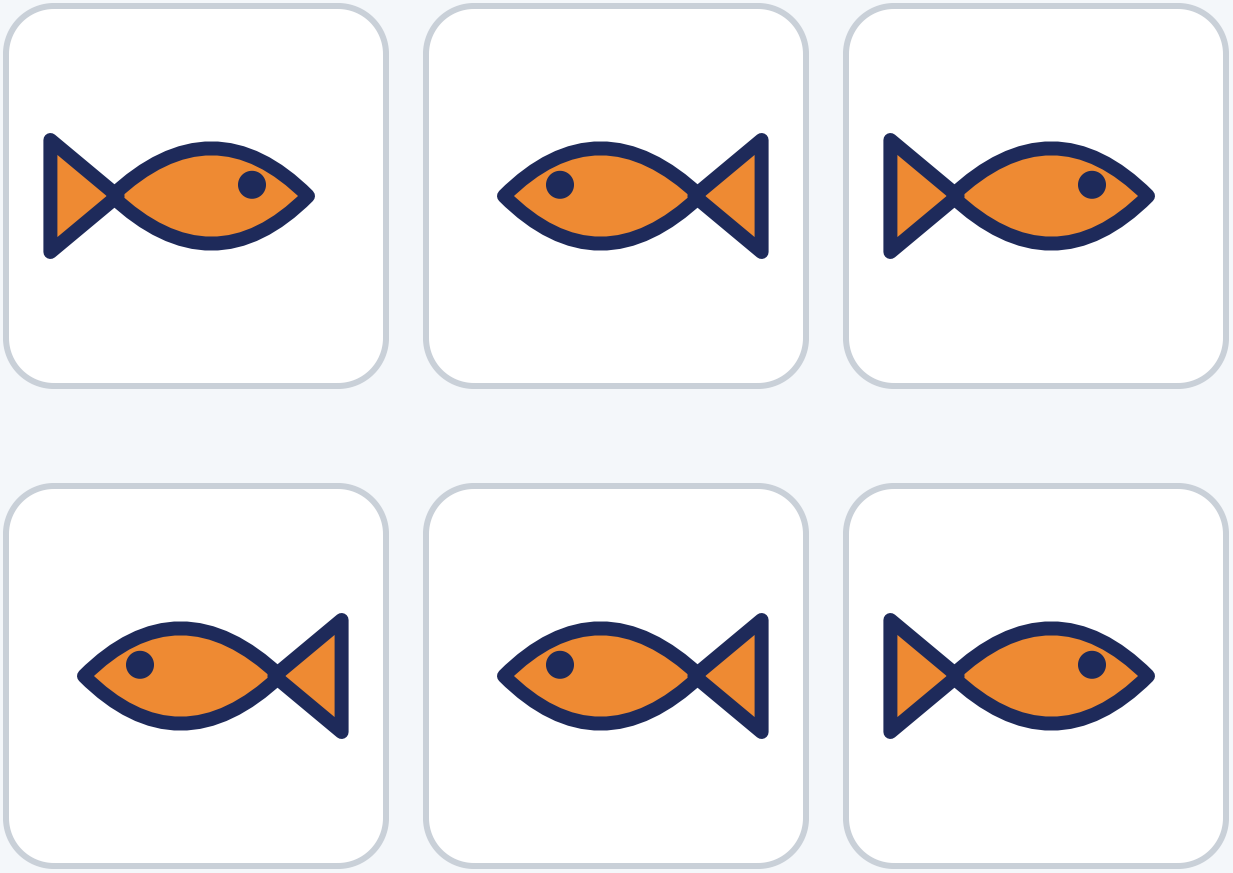
One cat is on the table. One cat is under the table. One cat is in the box. Color the cat under the table.



This way!

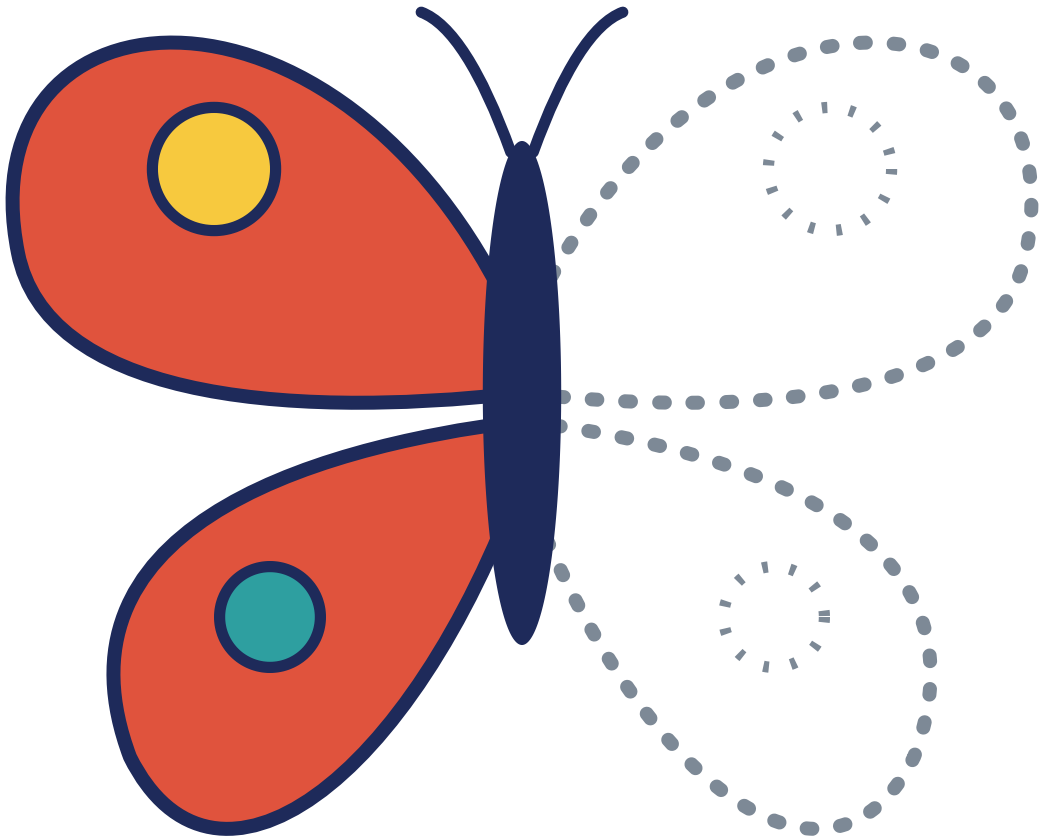
Circle the fish that swim this way →

this way



Mirror butterfly

Trace the other half of the butterfly. Make both sides the same. Then color it.



Where is this piece?

Only one circle comes from this painting.
Which one? Circle the letter.

A

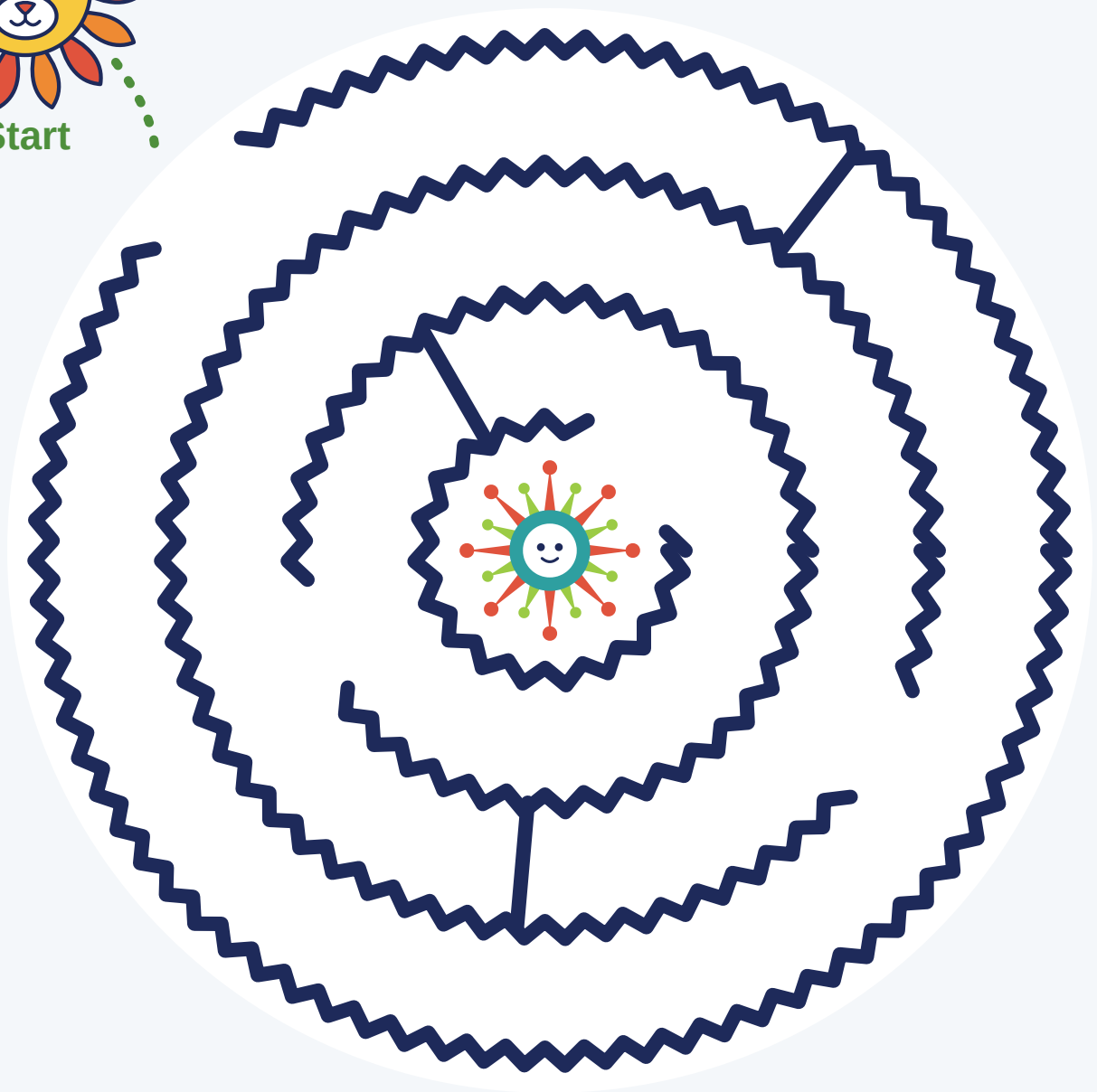
B

C

Artwork: Robert de Farias

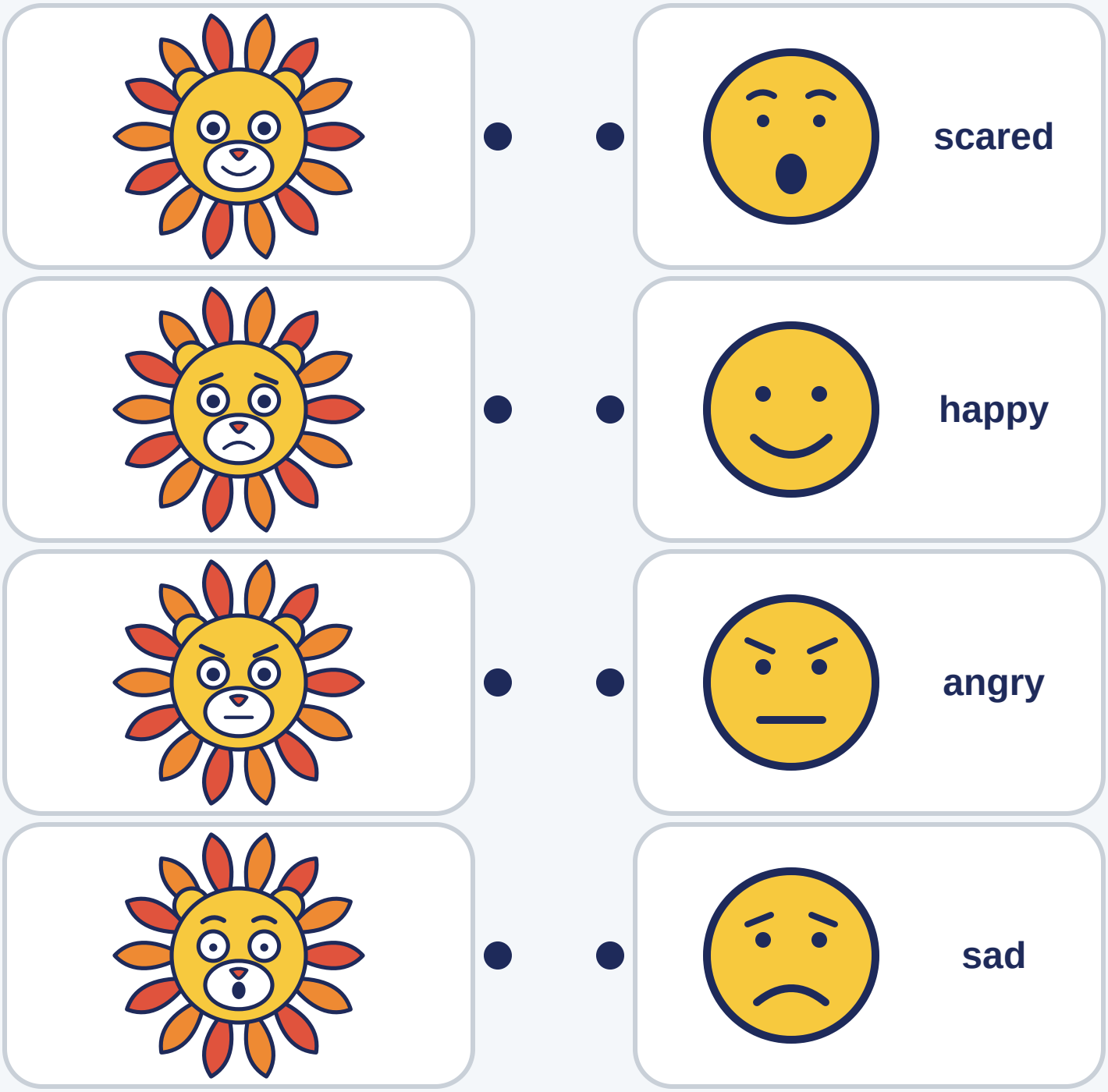
Help Leon find Luz

Find the way through the lines to Luz in the middle.



How does Leon feel?

Draw a line from each Leon to the face that feels the same.



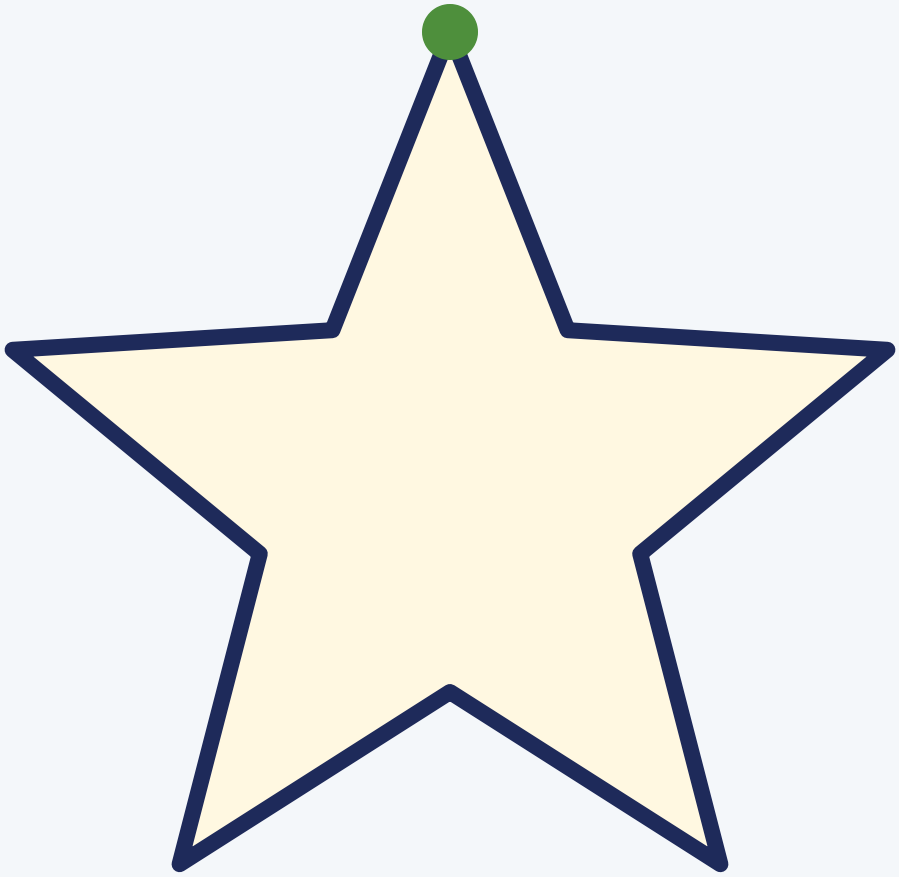
For grown-ups: read the words aloud. Ask: when do you feel like this?

What happened?

Look at what happened to Leon. How does he feel? Circle the face.

Star breathing

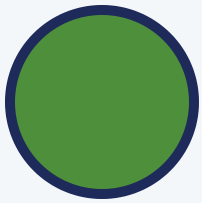
Trace the star slowly with your finger. Breathe in as you go up. Breathe out as you go down.



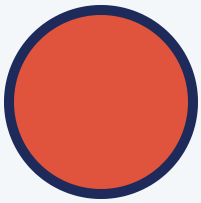
Up a point: breathe in. Down: breathe out.

Stop and go

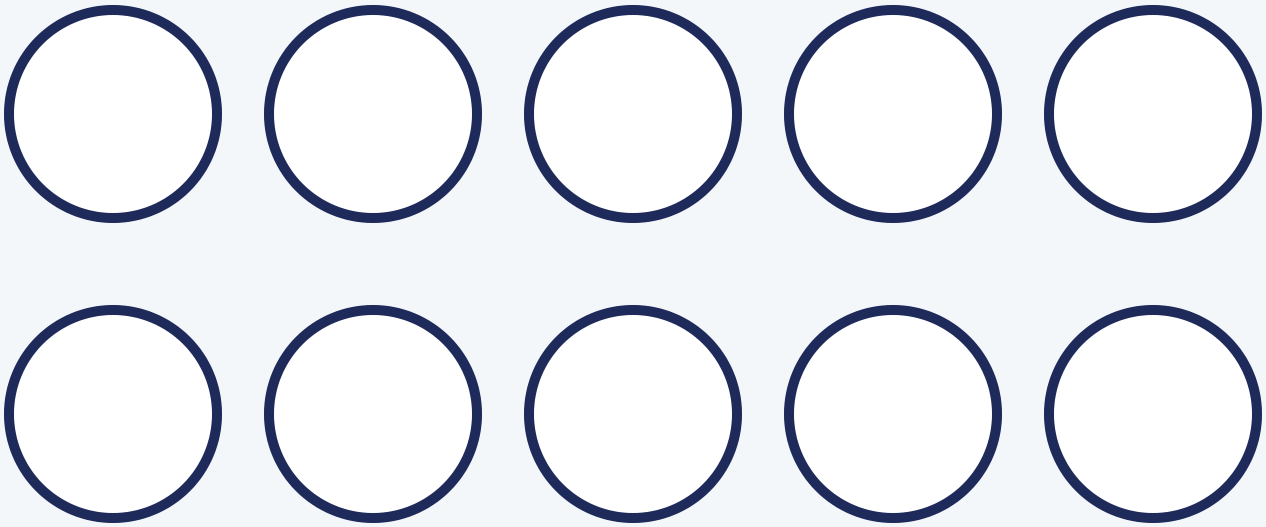
Color a circle only when you hear “Go!” Stop when you hear “Stop!”



GO



STOP



For grown-ups: say “Go!” and let your child color. Say “Stop!” and the pencil goes down. Mix short and long turns. Laugh together when someone moves on “Stop”!

Kind choices

A grown-up reads each story. Color the heart next to the kind thing to do.

Luz dropped her blocks.

- Leon helps pick them up.
- Leon walks away.

There is one cookie left.

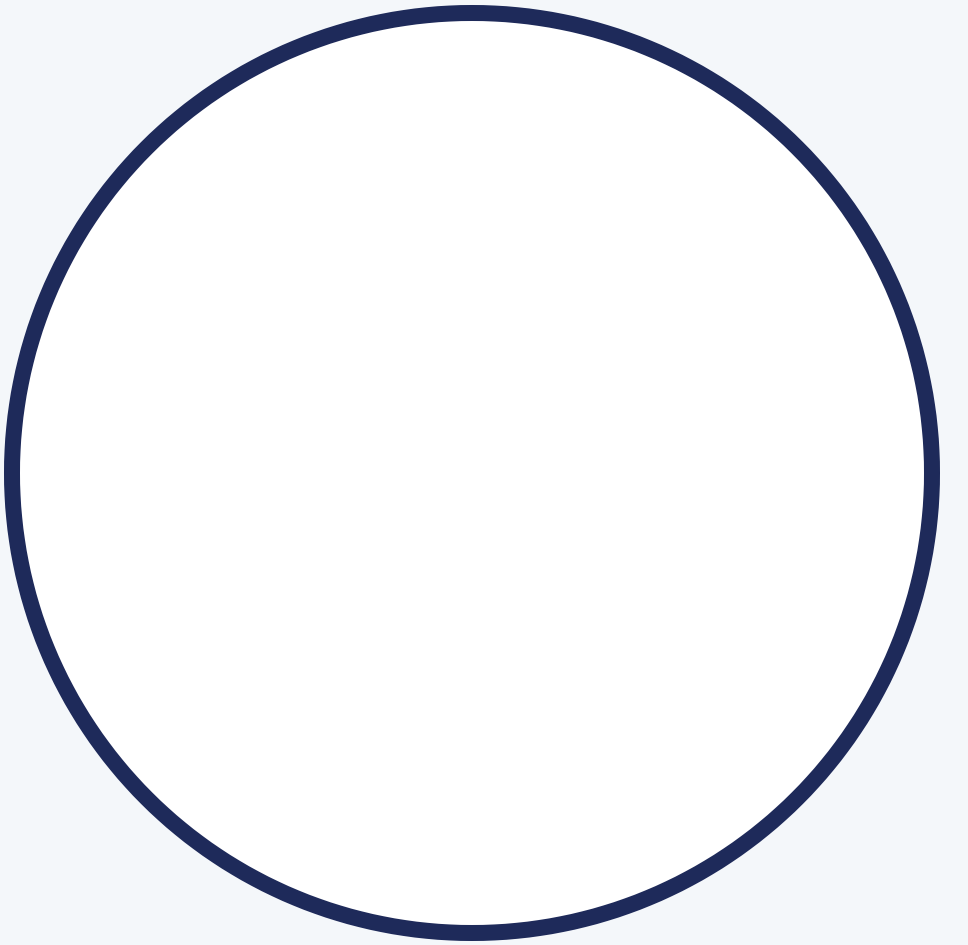
- Leon keeps it all.
- Leon shares it with Luz.

Luz is sad.

- Leon gives her a hug.
- Leon laughs at her.

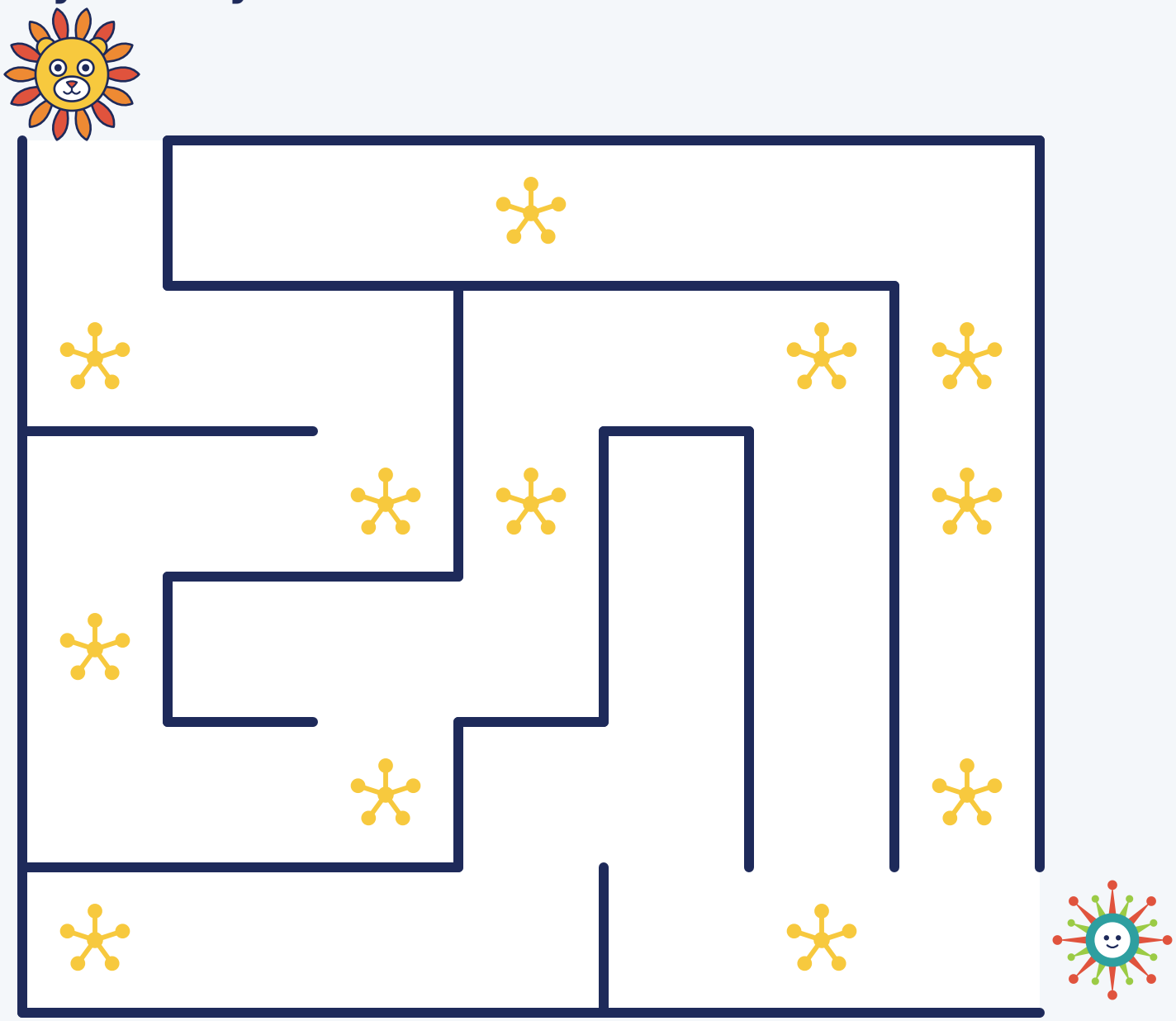
My face today

How do you feel today? Draw your face.



Star maze

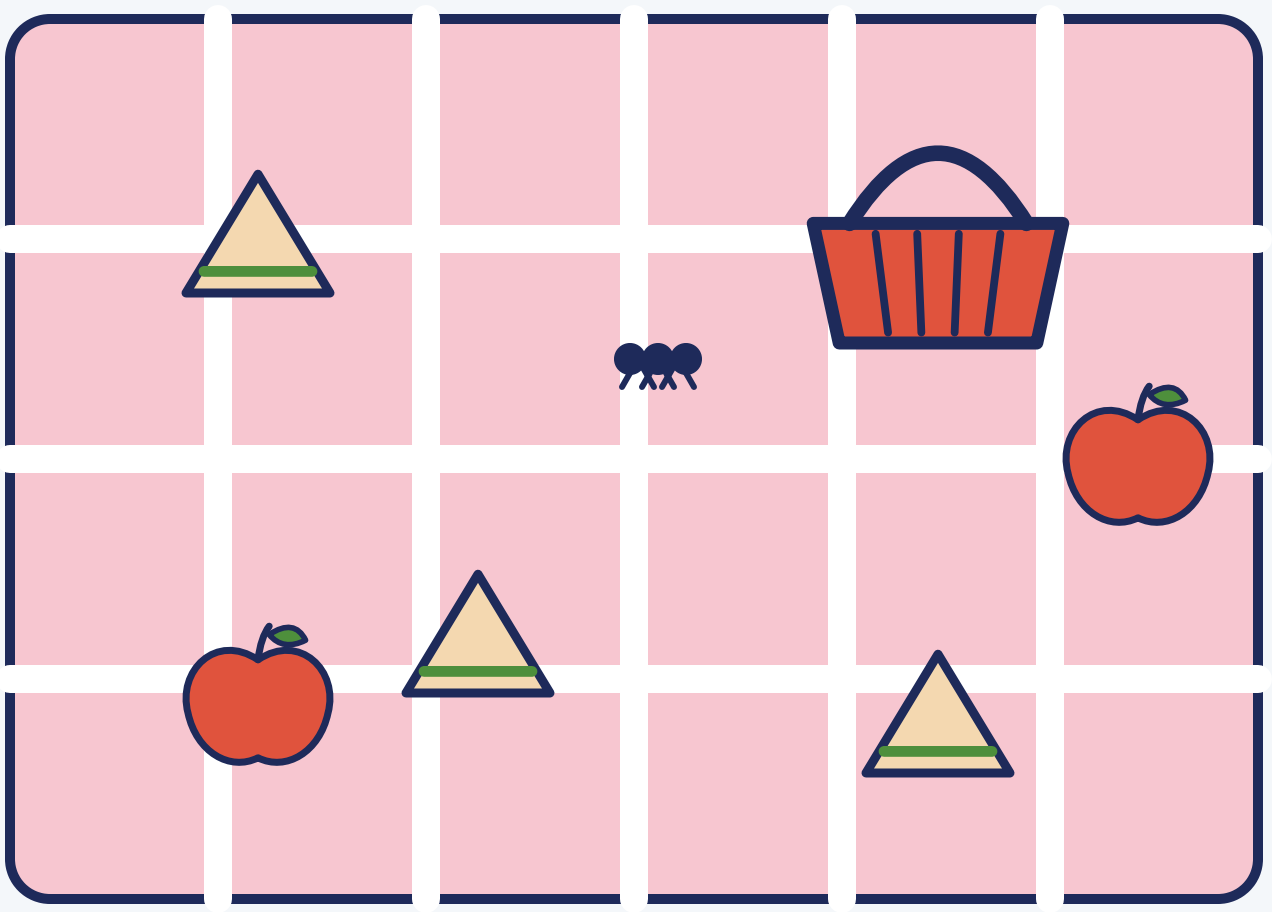
Help Leon reach Luz. Count the stars on your way.



I found ☐ stars on my way.

Picnic puzzle

Look at the picnic. Then cover it and answer your grown-up.



For grown-ups: let your child look for 20 seconds. Cover the picture and ask:
1. How many sandwiches? 2. What color is the basket? 3. How many ants? 4. How many apples?

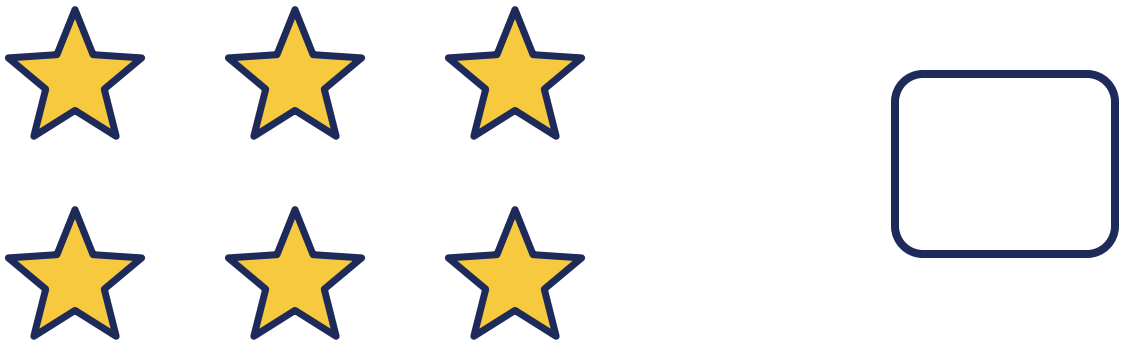
Super mix

1. Draw what comes next. 2. Circle the odd one out. 3. Count the stars.

1

2

3



Great thinking!

This certificate is for

for finishing Leon’s Thinking Book, Volume 1

Signed: Leon & Luz

Answers for grown-ups

Some pages have many good answers. Talk about them together!

p. 8	**Find the stars**	6 stars.
p. 9	**Sock pairs**	Striped → 2nd, dotted → 4th, zigzag → 5th, white heel → 1st, white top → 3rd.
p. 10	**Odd one out**	Row 1: 3rd. Row 2: 1st. Row 3: 4th. Row 4: 2nd.
p. 11	**3 little differences**	Bottom picture: the sun is missing, the tree is missing, the balloon is blue.
p. 12	**Hidden fish**	5 fish.
p. 13	**Balloon strings**	Luz has the red balloon (middle).
p. 14	**Find the shadow**	C (the bird the right way up).
p. 15	**Ladybug spots**	4 ladybugs: top row 1st and 4th; bottom row 1st and 4th.
p. 16	**Luz goes to the market**	Apple, cup, star.
p. 18	**What did you see?**	1st, 3rd and 5th circles (black, blue, yellow-brown).
p. 20	**Color the circles**	1 red, 2 blue, 3 green.
p. 22	**What is missing?**	B (the red circle).
p. 23	**Look, cover, draw**	Drawings that look like the models (a house, a circle with a dot, a cross).
p. 24	**Shape robot**	5 circles red (2 eyes, 2 buttons, the ball on the antenna). 3 squares blue (head and 2 hands).
p. 25	**Castle triangles**	5 triangles (3 roofs and 2 flags).
p. 26	**Shapes around us**	Circle → clock, triangle → pizza slice, square → window, rectangle → door.
p. 27	**Color by number**	A turtle: head and feet green, shell yellow, water blue.
p. 28	**Big and small**	Biggest: row 1 → 2nd, row 2 → 3rd, row 3 → 1st. Smallest: row 1 → 3rd, row 2 → 1st, row 3 → 2nd.
p. 30	**What comes next?**	Row 1: B. Row 2: A. Row 3: A.

Answers for grown-ups (continued)

p. 31	**Bead necklace**	Red, blue, red, blue.
p. 32	**Sun and moon**	Row 1: moon (sun, moon, moon, sun, moon...). Row 2: sun (moon, sun, sun, moon, sun...).
p. 33	**Big, small, big**	Row 1: A (small). Row 2: B (big). Row 3: A (small).
p. 35	**Pattern train**	A circle.
p. 36	**What goes together?**	Circle 1 → painting 3. Circle 2 → painting 1. Circle 3 → painting 2.
p. 37	**One color or many?**	One color: 1, 3, 5. Many colors: 2, 4, 6.
p. 38	**Who am I?**	1: fish. 2: sun. 3: cup.
p. 39	**First, next, last**	Seed 1, sprout 2, flower 3 (left to right: 3, 1, 2).
p. 40	**Which does not belong?**	Row 1: house (not an animal). Row 2: boat (not a fruit). Row 3: cup (not in the sky).
p. 41	**Dry feet**	Path B.
p. 42	**Leon’s color grid**	Top right: yellow. Middle left: blue. Bottom middle: red.
p. 43	**How many?**	3, 2, 5, 4.
p. 44	**Count to 10**	7 stars, 9 apples, 6 fish, 10 suns, 8 boats.
p. 45	**Which has more?**	Row 1: right box. Row 2: left box. Row 3: right box.
p. 46	**Number path**	1 → 2 (right) → 3 (down) → 4 (right) → 5 (down) → 6 (right) → 7 (down) → 8 (down) → 9 (right).
p. 47	**Dot to dot**	A fish.
p. 48	**Adding apples**	3, 4, 4, 5.
p. 49	**Flying away**	3, 3, 0.
p. 50	**Missing numbers**	3, 5, 7, 8.
p. 51	**Make 5**	Add 2, add 4, add 1.

Answers for grown-ups (continued)

p. 52	**Letter hunt**	8 letters (big A and small a). Rows: row 1: 2; row 2: 2; row 3: 2; row 4: 1; row 5: 1; row 6: 0.
p. 53	**First letters**	Sun → S, ball → B, cat → C, moon → M.
p. 54	**Same first sound**	Sock, snake, star.
p. 55	**Rhyme time**	Cat → hat, moon → spoon, fish → dish, bee → tree.
p. 57	**Word and picture**	SUN → sun (2nd), CAT → cat (3rd), CUP → cup (1st).
p. 58	**Listen and do**	Blue hat, a sun drawn in the sky, an X on the fish.
p. 59	**Tell the story**	Left to right: 2, 3, 1 (plant the seed, water it, the flower grows).
p. 60	**Top shelf**	The bird and the blue circle.
p. 61	**Where is the cat?**	The cat on the floor between the table legs.
p. 62	**This way!**	3 fish: top left, top right, bottom right.
p. 63	**Mirror butterfly**	Both wings the same, with the same spots and colors.
p. 64	**Where is this piece?**	B (top right of the painting).
p. 65	**Help Leon find Luz**	Enter at the top left, go down and around to the right side, then keep turning toward the middle (one way only).
p. 66	**How does Leon feel?**	Happy → 2nd, sad → 4th, angry → 3rd, scared → 1st.
p. 67	**What happened?**	Dropped ice cream: sad. Birthday cake: happy. Thunder: scared.
p. 70	**Kind choices**	Helps pick them up. Shares it with Luz. Gives her a hug.
p. 72	**Star maze**	7 stars on the only path from Leon to Luz (5 more stars are on wrong turns).
p. 73	**Picnic puzzle**	3 sandwiches, a red basket, 1 ant, 2 apples.
p. 74	**Super mix**	1: triangle. 2: the fish. 3: 6 stars.

Answers for grown-ups (continued)

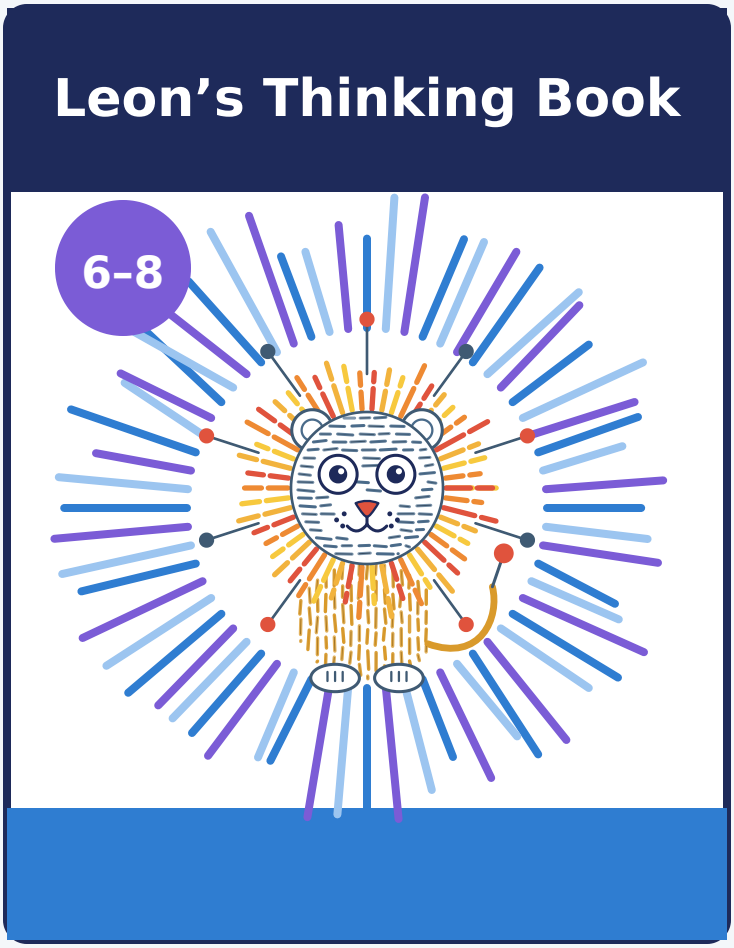
Picture answers

p. 64

B (top right of the painting).

See you in Volume 2!

For ages 6 to 8



More challenges with Leon and Luz: secret codes, logic grids, sudoku, treasure maps, word games, mazes and planning puzzles.

Look for **Leon’s Thinking Book, Volume 2** by Robert de Farias.